

RAKSHA BANDHAN LOSES SOME SWEETNESS AS COSTS BITE **P3**



PM FLAGS INDIA'S ABSENCE FROM HALF OF OLYMPIC EVENTS **P5**

THE ICONIC CHARACTER GIFTED STAR **P14**



TO VISIT UZBEKISTAN, KYRGYZSTAN

PM Modi to meet Putin on sidelines of SCO Summit

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 27

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will begin a four-day trip on Saturday to strengthen ties with Uzbekistan and attend the annual Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) summit in Kyrgyzstan.

In the first leg of the trip, the Prime Minister will travel to Uzbekistan's capital Tashkent from August 29 to 30 on a bilateral visit to explore ways to further bolster the bilateral ties in diverse sectors, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said here on Thursday.

PM Modi will then visit Kyrgyz Republic for the 26th SCO Summit from August 31 August to September 1. He is set to hold bilateral talks with Russian President Vladimir Putin on the sidelines of the SCO summit in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan as the two leaders are expected to discuss key bilateral, regional and global issues, the MEA said.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar recently met President Putin during his two-day visit to Russia. Putin said he hoped his future meeting with PM Modi would take place on the sidelines of the SCO summit. **CONTINUED ON P4**

Nepal floods toll hits 392, over 1,500 missing as rescuers race against time

Bhote Koshi and Trishuli river corridors suffered widespread destruction



MPOST BUREAU

Kathmandu, August 27

The death toll from the flash floods triggered by a glacial collapse near the Nepal-Tibet border rose to 392 on Thursday, with 359 deaths reported in Nepal and three in neighbouring Tibet. Rescue teams were searching for 1,468 people still missing on both sides of the border, including 910 in Nepal and 558 in Tibet. Among those

KEY POINTS

- » Nepal reports 359 deaths and 910 missing
- » Tibet reports three deaths and 558 missing
- » Glacial collapse triggered an ice-rock avalanche near the Nepal-Tibet border

- » Nepal says 290 Indian nationals remain missing
- » Avalanche debris blocked the Lhende River before unleashing a massive surge
- » Floodwaters devastated Rasuwa's Timure and Rasuwagadhi settlements

- » USGS ruled out an earthquake, identifying glacial collapse and debris flow

reported missing in Nepal are 290 Indian nationals.

The disaster began on

Wednesday after an ice-rock avalanche linked to a glacial

collapse struck **CONTINUED ON P4**

Fresh flood risk persists as new lake forms

MPOST BUREAU

Kathmandu, August 27

A new flood threat has emerged in Nepal's Rasuwa district after a barrier lake formed near the source of the Bhote Koshi River, with Chinese authorities warning that the lake could breach and send water downstream.

The Department of Hydrology and Meteorology (DHM) said Thursday that it had received information from China about the lake's formation at a river blockage site near the Nepal-China border. The Chinese government conveyed the information to Nepal's Ministry of Foreign Affairs, which passed it on to the department.

CONTINUED ON P4

India steps up rescue efforts for 290 missing, 200 stranded Indians

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

New Delhi, August 27

At least 290 Indians remain uncontactable, and around 200 others are stranded on the Chinese side after flash floods devastated areas along the Nepal-Tibet border, prompting India to coordinate with authorities in Nepal and China for their rescue and evacuation. The floods have killed more than 260 people and swept away bridges, roads and hydropower projects in Nepal.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar held a high-level meeting with senior officials and India's envoys to Kathmandu and Beijing on Thursday to review the situation. "Urgent efforts are underway to ascertain the status and well-being of all Indians in the flood-affected areas," he said.

MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said the 290 uncontactable Indians include 73 people working at the Trishuli One hydropower project. India's embassy in Kath-

KEY POINTS

- » 73 missing Indians are linked to the Trishuli One power project
- » 21 Tamil Nadu nationals rescued; several Mansarovar pilgrims remain stranded
- » India has sent 47.5 tonnes of relief supplies to Nepal
- » Jaishankar: "Urgent efforts" underway to locate and rescue Indians

mandu is in touch with the project's head to establish their status.

Several groups travelling for the Kailash Mansarovar Yatra are also among those unaccounted for. Two groups of 37 and 49 Indians from Tamil Nadu travelled through Samrat and Fly Everest travel agencies. Another group of 32 Indians from West Bengal travelled to Timure in Rasuwa district through Samrat Travels. There are also 61 Indians from other states and a group of 33 from Kerala. **CONTINUED ON P4**

Briefs

DU student stabbed to death at home

NEW DELHI: Police suspect 26-year-old Imran stabbed a 21-year-old Delhi University SOL student at her Tilak Nagar home on Wednesday, allegedly over her talking to another man. CCTV showed him entering around 5:40 pm. A PCR call was received at 7:24 pm. Police have formed over 15 teams to trace the absconding accused. **SEE P2**

Pilot, instructor killed in training aircraft crash

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

Kanpur, August 27

Two pilots were killed when a Tecnam P2006T twin-engine training aircraft operated by Garg Aviation crashed near Nathapurwa village in the Katri area of Kanpur on Thursday, around 20 minutes after taking off from Kanpur Civil Airport. The aircraft, carrying an instructor and a trainee pilot, crashed about five nautical miles from the airport near the Ganga Barrage.

According to preliminary information from the Civil Aviation Ministry, the aircraft, registered as VT-NBV, took off at around 11:30 am for a training flight in the airport's local flying area. Both occupants suffered fatal injuries. Kanpur Commissioner of Police Raghubir Lal identified them as instructor Sachin Bhatia of Gujarat and trainee pilot Abhishek Pujari of Karnataka. Bhatia had about 3,000 **CONTINUED ON P4**

NCLT clears Chandra's Rs 6.5-crore payout, 99.97% haircut sparks backlash

HDFC Bank, with a Rs 680-cr claim, considers NCLAT appeal

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 27

The National Company Law Tribunal's approval of a repayment plan for Essel Group founder Subhash Chandra has triggered criticism from lenders and the Congress, with HDFC Bank saying it is considering an appeal, while Chandra maintained that the proceedings concern

only his liability as a personal guarantor and not debt personally borrowed by him.

The NCLT approved a plan under which creditors will receive about Rs 6.25 crore, with another Rs 25 lakh earmarked for process costs. The figure has been described publicly as a Rs 6.5 crore payout against admitted claims of about Rs

22,006.57 crore, implying a recovery of roughly 0.03 per cent from Chandra's personal estate and a 99.97 per cent haircut on those claims.

Chandra disputed the characterisation of the claims, saying the total claim against him as a personal guarantor in the personal insolvency proceedings is Rs 3,992 crore.

CONTINUED ON P4

RAKHI RUSH



People browse 'rakhis' at a roadside shop on the eve of 'Raksha Bandhan' festival at Koti circle, in Hyderabad, Telangana, on Thursday

J P Nadda meets Reservation Hatao Andolan protesters

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 27

The government has opened a dialogue with representatives of the Reservation Hatao Andolan, with Union minister J P Nadda holding a meeting with three members of the group on Thursday, less than a week after an anti-reservation protest at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi.

CONTINUED ON P4

38 DISTRICTS CLASSIFIED AS LARGE DEFICIENT

Monsoon rainfall 13% below normal so far, 14 states record deficits

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 27

India's cumulative monsoon rainfall remained 13 per cent below normal between June 1 and August 26, with 14 states and Union Territories recording deficient rainfall, according to the latest data from the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

The country received 577.8 mm of rain during the period against the normal 664.7 mm. The regional distribution showed the sharpest shortfalls in east

TAKEAWAYS

- » India received 577.8 mm rainfall against the normal 664.7 mm
- » Fourteen states and Union Territories recorded deficient rainfall
- » East and northeast India faced a 27% rainfall deficit
- » The region received 759.6 mm against 1,037.1 mm normally



and northeast India and the southern peninsula. East and northeast India received 759.6 mm against

the normal 1,037.1 mm, a deficit of 27 per cent. The southern peninsula recorded **CONTINUED ON P4**



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Raksha Bandhan loses some sweetness as costs bite

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 27

As Delhi gears up to celebrate Raksha Bandhan, a sharp rise in sugar prices has left Delhi's sweet shops caught between rising production costs and cautious customers. While the festival has traditionally brought a surge in demand, local sweet sellers in some areas said orders and footfall have fallen by nearly 20 per cent this year as consumers cut back on purchases amid higher prices.

Shopkeepers said the wholesale price of sugar, which was around Rs 5000 per quintal earlier,

has climbed to nearly Rs 7,000-7500, pushing up the cost of preparing popular sweets. The increase comes on top of already high prices of milk, paneer, dry fruits, ghee and other ingredients, making it difficult for small outlets to maintain their earlier rates.

"We have been forced to increase prices because our input costs have gone up sharply. But customers are also feeling the pinch. This year, many people are buying smaller quantities or placing fewer orders," said a sweet shop owner in Sangam Vihar.

Another trader in Tughlaqabad said the



impact was visible not only at the counter but also in advance orders. "Normally, Raksha Bandhan brings bulk orders from families and offices. This time, orders are down by around 20 per cent. We

are also producing less because there is no point making large quantities if the demand is uncertain," he said.

The impact is being felt at the production stage as well. Shopkeep-

SUGAR, LPG PRICE HIKE PUSHES UP SWEET PRICES; SELLERS CLAIM 20% FALL IN RAKSHA BANDHAN ORDERS IN DELHI

ers said a 14-kg LPG cylinder now costs around Rs 2,200, further increasing their operating expenses. Several local sweet makers said they have reduced production ahead of the festival to avoid wast-

age amid weaker orders. "Every ingredient has become expensive, but sugar and LPG have added significantly to our costs. We are producing less this time because orders are lower and we do not want unsold sweets after Raksha Bandhan," said Pankaj, a sweet shop owner in Govindpuri. "Earlier, if we spent Rs 500 on ingredients and preparation, the same quantity can now cost around Rs 700-800. We cannot absorb the entire difference," he added.

Some shops have increased rates by around Rs 20-30 per kg, while others are holding prices

steady for the festival to retain customers, despite the squeeze on margins. Sellers said premium varieties such as dry-fruit sweets are particularly affected because of the combined increase in sugar and other ingredients.

For buyers, however, the festival budget has become tighter.

"I usually buy sweets for relatives and neighbours during Raksha Bandhan, but this year I am having to buy less. Prices have increased and there are other festival expenses as well," said Shivam, a resident of Saket.

Another customer at a

sweet shop said, "We cannot stop buying sweets during Raksha Bandhan, but instead of buying a large box, we are choosing a smaller one. The prices are definitely affecting how much we purchase."

Traders said they expect demand to pick up around the festival, but are keeping production controlled as they remain uncertain about post-festival sales. For neighbourhood sweet shops, the combination of expensive ingredients, higher cooking costs and cautious consumers has made this Raksha Bandhan less lucrative than usual.

Narela on campus radar as IGDТУW eyes expansion

Govt plans new campus to boost technology, research...

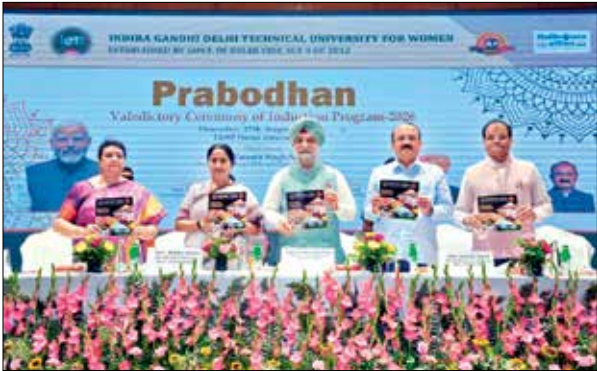
OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 27

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday said her government was actively working towards providing the Indira Gandhi Delhi Technical University for Women (IGDTUW) with a new campus in the Narela Education Hub, as the university highlighted its growing footprint in technology, innovation and research.

Addressing the valedictory ceremony of the 'Prabodhan' Induction Programme-2026 at IGDТУW, Gupta said the proposed campus would help expand the university's reach and enable more students from Delhi and across the country to pursue technical education. "We want to make sure that not just 1,000 students, but a large number of students from across the country as well as Delhi can study here," she said.

The programme was attended by Delhi Lieutenant Governor and IGDТУW Chancellor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Education Minister Ashish Sood.

A state-of-the-art lecture hall complex was also inaugurated at the university during the event. The complex has been equipped



INNOVATION

» CM said the proposed campus would help expand the university's reach and enable more students from Delhi and across the country to pursue technical education

» We want to make sure that not just 1,000 students, but a large number of students from across the country as well as Delhi can study here: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta

» The programme was attended by Delhi L-G and IGDТУW Chancellor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Education Minister Ashish Sood

with modern facilities for teaching, interaction and knowledge exchange, according to the Delhi government officials.

Gupta said the induction programme marked the beginning of a new journey for students, which could bring both excitement and anxiety, but expressed confidence in their ability to pursue their goals.

"A new journey starts for the students today, a journey that might cause excitement and anxiety at the same time. But I am sure the girls present today are more than capable to follow their dreams," she said.

Highlighting the university's significance, Gupta said IGDТУW, established in 2013, was Asia's first government women's technical

university and had challenged the perception that technical education was a male-dominated field.

She urged students to move beyond merely using existing technologies and become creators of artificial intelligence and other emerging technologies.

"Technology, knowledge and experience have no gender," Gupta said, calling upon students to become job creators rather than merely job seekers.

The university has expanded opportunities in emerging areas such as robotics and artificial intelligence, cyber security, and mathematics and computing, the press release said.

Under the NETRA-NAARI-NETRITVA initiative, 75 surveillance drones have been developed and demonstrated for the Delhi Police, it said. The government has also supported a Centre of Excellence for Advanced Drone Technology with around Rs 8 crore and established a Centre of Excellence in Cyber Security, according to the officials. The recent placement season saw IGDТУW students receive more than 1,000 placement offers, with the highest package touching Rs 1 crore, it said.

Min reviews NDMC waterlogging

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 27

Delhi PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh on Thursday ordered officials to fix accountability for waterlogging incidents in the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) area, warning that negligence leading to a recurrence would invite action against

those responsible. Singh chaired a review meeting at the NDMC Conference Hall to assess the waterlogging reported across parts of the New Delhi area following heavy rainfall in the national capital. Senior officials, including chief engineers and heads of departments concerned, attended the meeting.

The minister directed

officials to strengthen the civic body's preparedness and ensure that complaints of waterlogging are addressed without delay during spells of heavy rain.

Officials were also asked to identify shortcomings in the existing response mechanism and take corrective measures to prevent repeated disruption.

MCD committees set for leadership change

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, August 27

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi's committee system is set for a change in leadership, with councillors filing nominations on Thursday for the posts of Chairpersons and Deputy Chairpersons of its statutory, special and ad hoc committees.

The nominations were filed at the Municipal Secretary's office at the Civic Centre on the last day of the process. Mayor Pravesh Wahi, Deputy Mayor Monika Pant and Leader of the House Jai Bhagwan Yadav were present. The elections will be held during the first meetings of the committees on September 2 and 3.

The nominations bring together experienced

councillors and younger members across key civic portfolios. Senior councillor Mukesh Kumar Goel has been nominated as Chairperson of the Appointments, Promotions, Disciplinary and Allied Matters Committee, with Reena Maheshwari as Deputy Chairperson.

For the Works Committee, Preeti and Dharamvir Sharma have been nominated, while Vikesh Sethi and Ramesh Kumar Garg have been proposed for the Medical Relief and Public Health Committee. Sandeep Kapoor and Anita will head the Environment Management Services Committee if elected, while Narendra Kumar Singh and Veena Asija have been nominated for the Garden Committee.

Delhi ends segregation of certain women prisoners

Move follows SC concerns over discriminatory prison practices

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 27

Delhi has removed provisions that allowed certain women prisoners, including those accused or convicted under anti-trafficking laws, to be housed separately from other female inmates, following concerns raised in a Supreme Court-monitored exercise on discriminatory prison practices.

The changes were communicated to the court-appointed amicus curiae, senior advocate S Muralidhar, during consultations with states and Union territories on provisions in prison laws and jail manuals

that may result in unequal treatment of inmates.

The Delhi government has withdrawn three provisions – Rule 1434(III) and Rule 92(25) of the Delhi Prison Rules, 2018, and Section 28(2) of the Delhi Prisons Act, 2000.

One of the provisions specifically permitted the separation of sex workers and brothel-keepers from other women prisoners. Another allowed segregation of inmates categorised as having "known bad character".

The provision in the Delhi Prisons Act required women facing charges or convictions under the Immoral Traffic (Preven-

tion) Act, 1956, or offences described as involving "grave moral depravity", to be kept apart from other female prisoners.

The deletions come amid the Supreme Court's continuing examination of discriminatory practices in prisons. In his latest report submitted on July 30, Muralidhar noted that several prison manuals still contained provisions for segregating women labelled as prostitutes, brothel-keepers or procuresses.

The report said such rules appeared to rely on assumptions about the supposed influence of these prisoners on others and could reinforce stigma.

BOND OF LOVE



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta being applied 'tilak' by a child during the 'Raksha Bandhan' celebration, in New Delhi, on Thursday

PTI

Hindu Rao Hospital gets a modern-age makeover

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, August 27

For 75 years, Hindu Rao Hospital has remained a familiar name in Delhi's public healthcare system, serving generations of patients despite the growing demands placed on civic hospitals. Today, the hospital is attempting to balance its long public-service legacy with a push towards modernisation.

The 832-bed hospital has recently added several advanced medical systems, including a 4K laparoscopy system, C-Arm machine, Optical Coherence Tomography (OCT), fundus camera, visual field analyser, phacoemulsification machine and pneumatic lithotripter.

The casualty department has also been revamped, while a new integrated blood sample collection centre and upgraded facilities for physiotherapy,

WITH DEMAND CONTINUING TO REMAIN HIGH, THE ADMINISTRATION IS EXPLORING VERTICAL EXPANSION, HIGH-RISE STRUCTURAL PLANNING AND ROOFTOP UTILISATION TO OVERCOME SPACE CONSTRAINTS

including a modern gym, have been developed.

The hospital is also looking to make a routine visit less cumbersome for patients. An online registration system, which will allow patients to scan QR codes and register without standing in queues, is currently under development and is planned across the hospital's floors.

With demand continuing to remain high, the admin-

istration is exploring vertical expansion, high-rise structural planning and rooftop utilisation to overcome space constraints.

Its academic profile has expanded alongside its clinical services. The institution's teaching capacity has increased from 60 to 150 seats, while its DNB programme, which completed 25 years, has grown from 21 seats in 2001 to 51 accredited seats across 10 specialities.

On the surgical front, the hospital has 14 operation theatres and regularly conducts six to eight gall bladder surgeries. Despite the patient load, the waiting period for such procedures is around a month.

For a hospital with a 75-year legacy, these changes represent an effort to ensure that its next chapter is defined not only by its history, but by how effectively it responds to the needs of Delhi's patients.

Capital logs 166 fresh H1N1 cases, tally 2,612

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 27

Delhi reported 166 fresh H1N1 cases in the last 24 hours, an increase from the 138 cases recorded the previous day, taking the cumulative tally to 2,612, as Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh inspected H1N1 preparedness at Indira Gandhi Hospital in Dwarka on Thursday.

The cumulative number of Influenza-A cases in the national capital has also risen to around 3,300 from 3,177 reported a day earlier, according to Delhi government data.

During his visit, Singh examined the special H1N1 isolation ward at

the hospital and reviewed arrangements for patient treatment and care. This included checking the availability of beds, oxygen, medicines, fluids, testing facilities, and other essential medical infrastructure, officials said.

He also interacted with doctors, healthcare workers and patients and reviewed information, education and communication material being used for public awareness on H1N1 prevention, symptoms and precautions. The hospital has established a dedicated Swine Flu/H1N1 clinic where suspected patients will first be examined and tested.

PLAN TO STRENGTHEN TRAUMA CARE AT DISTRICT HOSPITALS

Nadda reviews progress of projs announced in Budget for health

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 27

Union Health Minister J P Nadda on Thursday reviewed the progress of key projects and initiatives announced for the health sector in the Union Budget 2026-27, with a focus on ensuring their timely implementation, effective inter-ministerial coordination and delivery of measurable outcomes.

Nadda took stock of the preparatory work undertaken by various departments of his ministry and emphasised that the budget announcements should translate into concrete programmes, strengthened institutions and enhanced healthcare capacities within



clearly-defined timelines. The minister reviewed the progress of an initiative to increase emergency and trauma-care capacity in district hospitals by 50 per cent through the establishment and strengthening of emergency and trauma care centres, a statement issued

CLOSER LOOK

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by the health ministry said. He was informed that following a post-budget webinar, three committees were formed to examine infrastructure, drugs, diagnostics and quality, human resources, academic expansion and skilling, and digital architecture and pre-hospital

integration. A comprehensive gap analysis of district hospitals against the Indian Public Health Standards (IPHS) has also been completed, the statement said. Based on patient load, infrastructure and overall readiness, 613 district

hospitals have been categorised for a phased implementation, with 160 district hospitals identified for the first phase and targeted for strengthening by march 2027. The second phase will cover 203 district hospitals and the third phase the remaining 250.

Nadda stressed the need for close monitoring so that the first phase progresses in a focused and time-bound manner.

The minister also reviewed the progress on the budget initiative to strengthen the Allied Health Professionals (AHPs) ecosystem, with the objective of adding one lakh AHPs over the next five years across 10 selected disciplines, the statement said.

BJP chief discusses poll roadmap with new team

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 27



BJP president Nitin Nabin on Thursday held a meeting with newly appointed national general secretaries of the party and discussed the roadmap for the upcoming assembly elections in various states, including Uttar Pradesh and Punjab.

The meeting, which lasted for more than three hours at the BJP headquarters here, was attended by all newly appointed national general secretaries including former Union minister Smriti Irani, and Rajya Sabha MPs Vinod Tawde and Satish Poonia.

BJP national general secretary (organisation) B L Santhosh was also present at the meeting.

“Chaired the first organisational meeting with the newly appointed National

General Secretaries at the BJP headquarters today,” Nabin said in a post on X after the meeting.

“Held detailed discussions on organisational preparations and the roadmap for the upcoming

Assembly elections in various states,” the BJP chief added.

The assembly polls are due in Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Goa, Himachal Pradesh and Gujarat in 2027. The BJP is in power in five of these poll-bound states, except Punjab and Himachal Pradesh. While the Aam Aadmi Party currently rules Punjab, the Congress is in power in Himachal Pradesh.

The BJP chief recently appointed Tawde as party’s in-charge of political affairs in Uttar Pradesh. Satish Poonia was made in-charge of party affairs in Punjab.

Later, in a post on X, Irani said, “The first meeting of the newly appointed national general secretaries was held under the chairmanship of the national president, Nitin Nabin, at the BJP headquarters.”

From page 1

Nepal floods

The Lhende River near the Nepal-China border, about 20 km northeast of the Rasuwagadhi border city. The avalanche temporarily blocked the river, creating a natural barrier that later broke apart and sent a huge volume of water, mud, rocks and debris downstream.

Rasuwa district, about 160 km from Kathmandu, was among the first areas hit. Settlements including Timure and Rasuwagadhi were inundated before the flood moved through the Bhote Koshi and Trishuli river system, damaging homes, vehicles, roads, bridges and hydropower infrastructure.

Nepal’s disaster management authorities said a debris-laden flood entered the Lhende River after the ice-rock landslide and later reached the Trishuli River after passing through Timure. A preliminary assessment by Nepalese authorities, supported by a revised analysis from the US Geological Survey, found that the event was caused by a glacial collapse and debris flow rather than an earthquake.

The USGS said analysis of long-period seismic waves showed that the event initially reported as a 4.4-magnitude earthquake was generated by the glacial collapse and resulting debris flow.

The scale of the destruction has made rescue work difficult. Nepalese security personnel have evacuated more than 800 people from affected districts, while helicopters, drones and ground teams continued searching isolated settlements, riverbanks and downstream areas. At least 44 Nepal Army personnel, 28 Nepal Police personnel and 13 Armed Police Force personnel are among those whose whereabouts remain unknown. Around 160 workers at hydropower projects and customs offices have also been reported missing. Nepal Police spokesperson Abi Narayan Kafle said 132 bodies had been recovered from Chitwan, the highest number among the affected districts. Other bodies were recovered from Rasuwa, Nuwakot, Dhading, Gorkha, Tanahun and Nawalparasi.

Infrastructure damage has further complicated access to the affected areas. The Department of Roads said the entire 42-km stretch between Betrawati in Nuwakot and Rasuwagadhi was damaged at multiple points, with several concrete bridges washed away. The National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority said 35 motorable bridges, 45 suspension bridges and about 40 km of black-topped roads were damaged.

The Trishuli and Devghat hydropower projects and other power infrastructure also suffered damage. Authorities were working to reopen the Galchhi-Baireni road in Dhading, an important route linking Kath-

mandu with other parts of Nepal and a key transit corridor for heavy and light vehicles.

The search also moved to hospitals, where relatives gathered to identify missing family members. At Tribhuvan University Teaching Hospital in Kathmandu, authorities displayed lists of people brought in for treatment and photographs of those who died. A separate desk was set up to collect information about missing people. Similar scenes were reported at Bharatpur Hospital in Chitwan, where the rising number of bodies put pressure on mortuary capacity.

Twenty-seven foreign tourists stranded in Rasuwa were rescued on Thursday, including 11 Indians, four South Koreans, two Italians and two US citizens. The nationalities of the remaining eight had not been confirmed by the Nepal Tourism Board. The group was flown to Kathmandu by the Nepal Army. Most Indian tourists affected by the disaster had been travelling towards Kailash Mansarovar in Tibet or Gosainkunda in Nepal’s Bagmati Province.

Nepal Prime Minister Balendra Shah visited Bidur Municipality in Nuwakot on Thursday to inspect flood-hit areas. In Tibet, Chinese Premier Li Qiang visited Gyirong Township to oversee rescue and relief operations. Chinese state media said the People’s Liberation Army’s Western Theatre Command had sent a directing group to coordinate military rescue efforts.

Nepal Foreign Minister Shirsir Khanal also spoke by telephone with senior officials in the US, the UK and several other countries. His office said they expressed solidarity with Nepal and committed to supporting search and rescue efforts.

Authorities were continuing to assess the full extent of the destruction as rescuers worked through damaged roads, collapsed bridges and heavy deposits of mud and debris, with some affected areas still difficult to reach.

PM Modi

The meeting between the two leaders is expected to focus on bilateral trade and economic cooperation.

On his fourth visit to Uzbekistan, PM Modi will hold delegation-level talks with President Mirziyoyev to further strengthen the strategic partnership between the two countries. The two leaders would review cooperation in trade and investment, defence, digital connectivity, energy, education and people-to-people domains and set the agenda for the road ahead. They will also share perspectives on advancing the shared developmental visions of Viksit Bharat 2047 and Uzbekistan-2030, the MEA said in a statement.

The Prime Minister is also expected to visit the Shastri Memorial in Tashkent and the Mahatma Gandhi Centre at the Tashkent State University of Oriental Studies.

From Tashkent, at the invitation of the President of Kyr-

gыз Republic Sadyr Zhaparov, PM Modi will travel to Bishkek to participate in the 26th SCO Summit. The Summit marks the 25th anniversary of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation, of which India has been a full member since 2017. PM Modi will address the Summit where he will highlight India’s priorities of Security, Connectivity and Opportunity at the forum, the MEA said.

He will also hold bilateral meetings with SCO leaders on the sidelines of the Summit. He will also attend the Opening Ceremony of the 6th World Nomad Games, a celebration of the rich cultural heritage of Central Asia. Chinese President Xi Jinping, Russian President Putin and Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif are among the leaders likely to attend the summit.

The SCO was established with the primary goal of countering terrorism, separatism, and extremism, which continue to remain a challenge, Secretary (West) at the MEA, Sibi George, said at a media briefing.

Modi will also hold bilateral meetings with SCO leaders on the sidelines of the summit. It is learnt that Putin will be among the leaders with whom the prime minister will hold bilateral meetings on the margins of the summit.

The prime minister is also set to attend the opening ceremony of the sixth World Nomad Games, a celebration of the rich cultural heritage of Central Asia.

Fresh flood risk persists

About 2 million cubic metres of water had accumulated in the lake by Thursday morning, according to Chinese authorities. They estimated that another 3 million cubic metres could flow into the lake over the next three days, increasing the possibility of a breach.

The lake has formed near the meeting point of the Chhochen Khola and Purepu Tsangpo rivers. Both rivers originate in Tibet and enter Nepal, where they become part of the Bhote Koshi river system.

The warning comes a day after a deadly flash flood struck central Nepal, killing hundreds. The DHM’s Flood Forecasting Division said the risk of further flooding remains in the Bhote Koshi and Trishuli river areas.

The department urged residents in downstream Bhote Koshi areas to stay away from riverbanks and remain in safe locations until further notice. Travellers, security personnel and search and rescue teams were also advised to remain alert. Chinese authorities are monitoring the lake and carrying out flood simulations and risk assessments to assess the impact of a possible breach and prepare emergency measures.

At an all-party meeting called by Rastriya Swatantra Party president Rabi Lamichhane, leaders also called for diplomatic consultations with China on cross-border glacier risks

and proposed a stronger disaster management system.

India steps up rescue

Jaiswal said 21 Tamil Nadu nationals had been rescued. He also confirmed that several Indians who travelled for the Mansarovar Yatra are stranded on the Chinese side.

Around 200 Indians in Tibet have sought assistance for evacuation. Of these, 95 are in Garchan and are moving towards Nepal, while four are in Geelong city and 13 are in Zutulpu. Indian authorities are working with the concerned agencies as the situation in the affected areas remains fluid.

India has also stepped up humanitarian assistance to Nepal. New Delhi sent 10 tonnes of Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief material on Wednesday and dispatched another 37.5 tonnes in a military transport aircraft on Thursday, taking the total to 47.5 tonnes.

The supplies include temporary shelters, blankets, hygiene kits, solar lamps, medicines and food packets. More relief material is expected to be sent in the coming days. Jaishankar said the government was coordinating with ministries, state governments, tour operators and other agencies while working closely with Nepal on rescue and relief operations.

The relief effort began after Prime Minister Narendra Modi spoke to Nepalese Prime Minister Balendra Shah and assured him of India’s “all possible humanitarian assistance”. Modi said India stood in solidarity with the people of Nepal and that Indian teams were coordinating with Nepalese authorities on rescue and relief work. Jaiswal said the immediate priority was to locate the missing Indians and assist those stranded in flood-hit areas. India remains in continuous contact with authorities on both sides of the border as rescue efforts continue.

NCLT clears

“I have not borrowed any money from any lender,” he said. According to his statement, Rs 620 crore of the claims has already been settled and borrowing entities have offered another Rs 1,063 crore. Those entities, he said, have so far repaid about Rs 43,000 crore to creditors and have assured that any remaining amount will also be settled.

The distinction is important because the Rs 22,006 crore figure represents claims admitted against Chandra as a personal guarantor for loans linked to Essel and Zee companies, rather than money borrowed by him directly. About Rs 2,574 crore relates to loans for which his personal guarantee was provided when the original borrowing took place, while many other guarantees were subsequently given as additional security.

The case began after Vivek Infracon defaulted on a Rs 170 crore loan from the then Indi-

abulls Housing Finance, for which Chandra had provided a personal guarantee. The default led to insolvency proceedings against him as guarantor and prompted claims from several other lenders.

The plan received 80.81 per cent of the creditors’ voting share. LIC Housing Finance, HDFC Bank, Axis Bank, Canara Bank, RBL Bank and Union Bank were among lenders opposing it. LIC Housing Finance had described the payout as “unviable and unlawful”.

The matter reached a third member after two NCLT members delivered a split verdict. NCLT member (judicial) Nilesh Sharma, in a 144-page order, rejected the objections. He said the resolution professional’s valuation showed Chandra’s personal estate was worth significantly less than the amount proposed under the plan. Rejecting the plan, he said, could leave Chandra facing bankruptcy and reduce the prospects of recovery.

The tribunal said creditors could continue pursuing the principal borrowers, securities and other assets. It also held that its role was not to replace the commercial judgment of creditors or decide whether the settlement amount was adequate.

HDFC Bank, whose total claim was Rs 680 crore, said only 3.2 per cent of its claim was admitted under the order. The bank said it had voted against the plan and was “exploring filing an appeal” before the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal. It inherited the loan facility from HDFC before the merger of the two banks.

The Congress attacked the decision, with Rahul Gandhi calling the NCLT “Neta-Company Loot Tribunal”. Congress leaders Jairam Ramesh and Ran-deep Singh Surjewala described the recovery as an extreme “haircut” and questioned the functioning of the insolvency process.

Creditors had also pointed to Chandra’s historical net worth of about Rs 45,888 crore in 2017 and Rs 40,562 crore in 2018, compared with a presently disclosed figure of around Rs 31.79 crore, seeking greater scrutiny of his assets. The Chandra case is separate from the broader corporate insolvency record. Up to March 2026, approved resolution plans had yielded about Rs 4.32 lakh crore in recoveries, equal to 116.85 per cent of liquidation value and 94.56 per cent of fair value. More than 32,000 cases involving assets worth about Rs 14 lakh crore were settled before admission to insolvency proceedings.

Scheduled commercial banks’ net non-performing assets also fell from 5.94 per cent in March 2018 to 0.48 per cent in September 2025, while the absolute amount declined from about Rs 5.2 lakh crore to Rs 94,000 crore. An IIM Ahmedabad study cited in the response found that companies resolved through insolvency recorded 76 per cent growth in sales, 50 per

cent growth in total assets, 50 per cent growth in employee expenses and 130 per cent growth in capital expenditure.

J P Nadda

Nadda said the meeting with Harsh Dubey, Ran Bahadur Singh Chauhan and Mrityunjay Pathak was held as scheduled and described the discussions as “cordial”. In a post on X, he said, “Following the movement that took place at Jantar Mantar on 21 August, cordial discussions were held, as per the pre-determined schedule.” He added that the government representatives and the group would meet again soon. Nadda did not disclose the venue or provide details of what was discussed.

The meeting followed the August 21 protest called by Reservation Hatao Andolan, an Instagram-based page. Protesters were seeking an end to caste-based reservation and demanded that economic criteria take precedence over caste while deciding eligibility for government support and quotas.

Several protesters were detained by Delhi Police, which said no permission had been granted for a protest, procession, demonstration or assembly at Jantar Mantar. Police and paramilitary personnel were deployed heavily around the area. Nadda’s meeting has since drawn questions from the Aam Aadmi Party and the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), which both sought clarity on the government’s position on the demand to reconsider caste-based reservation.

CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke asked Nadda to state the Modi government’s position on the August 21 movement and what Prime Minister Narendra Modi had to say about it. AAP Delhi president Saurabh Bharadwaj also asked Nadda to explain the government’s stand on the BJP Savarna Morcha’s demand for reconsideration of reservations.

Nadda and Union minister Jitendra Singh had earlier negotiated with CJP representatives, who ended their “Gen Z” protest last month following the resignation of then education minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

Monsoon

412.5 mm against 529.4 mm, leaving a 22 per cent shortfall.

Meghalaya recorded the largest state-level deficit at 58 per cent below normal, followed by Manipur at 43 per cent, Bihar at 42 per cent, Arunachal Pradesh at 40 per cent and Andhra Pradesh at 39 per cent.

Punjab recorded a 34 per cent deficit, while Goa and Puducherry were each 33 per cent below normal. Assam had a 25 per cent shortfall, followed by Lakshadweep at 24 per cent, Mizoram and Karnataka at 22 per cent each, Rajasthan at 21 per cent and Kerala at 20 per cent. The 14 deficient states and UTs were Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Manipur, Mizoram, Bihar, Punjab, Rajasthan, Goa, Andhra Pradesh, Puducherry, Karnataka, Kerala

and Lakshadweep.

District-level data for June 1 to August 25 showed considerable variation within states. Of the districts covered, 287 recorded normal rainfall, 80 received excess rainfall and 19 received large excess rainfall. Another seven districts were listed under the no-data category. At the same time, 310 districts were classified as deficient and 38 as large deficient.

Bihar had 32 deficient and three large-deficient districts among 38 listed. Assam had 18 deficient and one large-deficient district, while Meghalaya had three deficient and seven large-deficient districts. Andhra Pradesh recorded 24 deficient and one large-deficient district. Karnataka had 18 deficient and two large-deficient districts, while Kerala had six deficient districts.

Uttar Pradesh, with 75 districts in the IMD table, had 28 deficient and eight large-deficient districts. Rajasthan had 19 deficient districts, while Punjab recorded 14 deficient and four large-deficient districts. Despite the wider shortfall, some states received substantially more rain than normal. Odisha recorded 1,098 mm against a normal 856.7 mm, an excess of 28 per cent. Madhya Pradesh received 666.3 mm against 734.7 mm and remained in the normal category. Uttar Pradesh recorded an 11 per cent deficit with 501 mm against 564.3 mm, while Delhi received 498.7 mm against 415.8 mm, an excess of 20 per cent.

The IMD forecast subdued rainfall activity over Peninsular India in the following week. Fairly widespread to widespread rain was also expected at different periods over parts of Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, eastern India and northeast India through the end of August.

Pilot, instructor

hours of flying experience. Police and fire personnel reached the site, cordoned off the area and secured the wreckage for investigation. Videos showed the aircraft largely destroyed, with debris scattered around the fields. A seat was also found outside the wreckage, although officials have not said whether either pilot attempted to escape. The Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) will conduct a detailed probe, while a three-member DGCA team is scheduled to visit the site for regulatory oversight. Investigators will examine the aircraft’s airworthiness, maintenance records, flight details and training procedures. Garg Aviation said the aircraft, which had been with its Kanpur operation since 2023, had no maintenance-related deficiencies.

The crash follows a June 26 incident in Kanpur in which a pilot trainee was seriously injured by an aircraft propeller. The city’s flying club has operated for 31 years. Kanpur airport also witnessed a runway close call in 2022.

TANK OVERHAUL FACILITY FOUNDATION LAID IN MP

Defence production nears Rs 1.80L cr; exports touch Rs 39K crore: Rajnath

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA
Bhopal, August 27

India's defence production has risen nearly four-fold to around Rs 1.80 lakh crore over the past decade, while defence exports have climbed to close to Rs 39,000 crore, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh said on Thursday.

Speaking after laying the foundation stone for a Rs 472-crore tank overhaul facility at the Vehicle Factory Jabalpur (VFJ) in Madhya Pradesh, Singh said India's defence industrial base was expanding beyond the manufacture of weapons to include maintenance, refurbishment and upgrades of key military platforms.

Defence production stood at about Rs 46,000 crore in 2014, while exports were around Rs 1,000 crore, Singh said. The government is now aiming to raise annual defence exports to Rs 50,000 crore by 2028-29.

"The world's perception of India is changing," Singh said, linking the expansion of the defence sector to the broader Aatmanirbhar Bharat programme.

The new facility at the Jabalpur-based ordnance unit will overhaul T-72 and T-90 main battle tanks operated by the Indian Army. Once operational, it is expected to handle 80 tanks a year, helping address a gap in the Army's



Defence minister Rajnath Singh with MP CM Mohan Yadav and others during the laying of foundation stone of a tank overhaul facility at Jabalpur

HIGHLIGHTS

- » 'Under PM Modi's leadership and Rajnath Singh's efforts, India is rapidly moving towards defence self-reliance', said CM Yadav
- » 'Tanks still relevant in modern warfare despite rise of drones, AI and cyber warfare,' said Defence minister Rajnath Singh
- » Caption: Defence minister Rajnath Singh with MP CM Mohan Yadav and others during the laying of foundation stone of a tank overhaul facility at Jabalpur

overhaul capacity.

The Army requires around 230 such tanks to be overhauled annually. The Heavy Vehicles Factory at Avadi currently has

the capacity to overhaul about 150 tanks a year, with the proposed Jabalpur facility expected to cater to the remaining requirement, he said.

Singh described the project as an important addition to India's defence industrial ecosystem, saying it would strengthen the country's ability to support major combat platforms throughout their operational life cycle. He also said the project was expected to generate employment opportunities in the region.

The defence minister said the growing use of drones, precision missiles, satellites, artificial intelligence and cyber capabilities had transformed the nature of war-

fare, but had not made tanks irrelevant.

"The role of tanks has not ended; it is evolving," Singh said, arguing that armoured platforms would continue to play an important role in ground operations.

He said tanks retained their military significance because of their ability to combine mobility, protection and firepower, enabling troops to operate with protected mobility even in challenging terrain. The changing battlefield, he added, required armoured systems to be modernised and adapted rather than simply phased out.

Singh said the Jabalpur project represented a broader shift in India's defence manufacturing strategy, where domestic capability is increasingly being built not only for producing military equipment but also for sustaining, repairing and upgrading it over its entire service life.

Addressing the event, Chief Minister Mohan Yadav said that under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership and Defence Minister Rajnath Singh's efforts, India was rapidly moving towards self-reliance in defence. He said Singh's resolve and leadership had strengthened India's fight against terrorism and its global standing.

'No adverse impact of Nepal floods in UP & Bihar till now'

Situation being continuously monitored, says NDRF

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 27

The devastating flash floods in Nepal have had no adverse impact on border areas of Bihar and Uttar Pradesh so far, though authorities in both states remain on high alert and are closely monitoring the situation, officials said on Thursday.

NDRF Inspector General Narendra Singh Bundela said 20 teams, including nine in Bihar and 11 in Uttar Pradesh, have been deployed for evacuation, rescue and relief operations if required. One of the teams is stationed in Kushinagar district near Gorakhpur.

"There has not been any adverse impact of the flash floods in Bihar and Uttar Pradesh till now. We are monitoring the situation in coordination

with the two state governments and other agencies," Bundela said.

The Central Water Commission is also monitoring the situation. Authorities are keeping a close watch on the first barrage along the India-Nepal border at Valmikinagar in Bihar's West Champaran district on the Gandak River.

The water level of the Gandak, which rose sharply following the floods in Nepal, showed a receding trend on Thursday, providing relief to residents of low-lying areas in northern Bihar.

The discharge from the Valmikinagar barrage fell from 1.50 lakh cusecs at 11 pm on Wednesday to 1.04 lakh cusecs on Thursday morning. All 36 gates of the barrage had been opened after floodwaters from Nepal reached the structure.

The Water Resources Department said the river level began declining after peaking, though rainfall in Nepal's Devghat area later caused it to rise again. No adverse impact on embankments has been reported. The Ganga was also showing a declining trend, with a marginal rise of 1-2 cm possible at some locations, officials said.

Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary reviewed the situation with Chief Secretary Pratayya Amrit and senior officials on Wednesday and directed authorities to maintain round-the-clock vigilance.

Officials said the highest discharge from the barrage this year was 2.24 lakh cusecs on July 14, compared with 5.625 lakh cusecs recorded on September 28, 2024, and expected the situation to remain normal.

Punjab Police get 1,746 new recruits

Chandigarh, August 27

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Thursday handed over appointment letters to 1,746 newly recruited police personnel, saying the induction would strengthen the force and create employment opportunities for the state's youth.

Addressing the recruits at the passing-out parade at PAP Ground, Phillaur, Mann said 13,092 personnel had joined the Punjab Police over the past four-

and-a-half years, while recruitment of another 3,298 constables was underway.

He said 70,840 youth had received government jobs on merit under the "No Cash, No Farmaish" principle, with the recruitment process being transparent and free from recommendations.

Mann said the government had also approved 1,600 district-cadre posts in the police force -- 150 Inspectors, 450 Sub-

Inspectors and 1,000 Assistant Sub-Inspectors -- to be filled through departmental promotions.

Calling upon the new recruits to serve people with professionalism and dedication, Mann said the Punjab Police had the additional responsibility of guarding the state's 532-km border with a hostile neighbour.

He said the force was also playing a key role in the government's anti-drug campaign. MPOST

WCD Min hails NSG's 1st Mahila course

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, August 27

Union Women and Child Development Minister Annpurna Devi on Thursday welcomed the commencement of the first-ever Mahila Commando Conversion Course (MCCC) at the National Security Guard (NSG) Training Academy in Manesar, describing it as a significant step towards strengthening women's role in the country's security apparatus.

The maiden course will provide specialised training to women personnel from state police forces and Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs), equipping them for counter-terrorism and other specialised operations.

The training will cover weapons handling, tactical interventions, hostage rescue and anti-terrorism operations, officials said.

The programme aims to enhance the operational capabilities of women personnel and create a larger pool of trained women commandos for deployment in specialised security roles.

Sharing her views on X, Annpurna Devi said, "Women are being empowered in capacity, capability, numbers and opportunities under the visionary leadership of @narendramodi."

Hailing the initiative, the minister said "Nari Shakti" was increasingly entering roles that had traditionally been dominated by men.

The MCCC is expected to expand opportunities for women personnel in specialised operations while providing them with advanced counter-terrorism skills through training at the NSG academy.

Officials said the initiative would help state police forces and CAPFs meet complex and evolving security challenges by increasing the availability of trained women personnel for specialised assignments.

Briefs

Manipur:
4 killed in
militant attack

IMPHAL: At least four members of the Naga community were killed and one was injured when armed militants ambushed their vehicle in Kangpokpi district of Manipur, officials said. The militants attacked the vehicle in an isolated area between Makui Ashang and Thabamba Naga, killing the four on the spot, they said. All five victims belong to the Liangmai Naga community.

Postmaster
held in
Odisha

BHUBANESWAR: The CBI on Thursday arrested an absconding postmaster who was wanted in a post office savings fraud case, officials said. Shabda Swain, the then branch postmaster of Bonda in Odisha's Bargarh district, during her posting from 2008 to 2014.

CM reviews
Srinagar's
drainage...

SRINAGAR: Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Thursday directed time-bound action to strengthen drainage infrastructure in the summer capital of the Union Territory. The CM chaired a high-level meeting to review the drainage sector of Srinagar, with a focus on addressing waterlogging.

Hry Monsoon Session begins amid protests

SWATI MAHAJAN
Chandigarh, August 27

The Monsoon Session of the Haryana Assembly began on Thursday amid a major protest by the Opposition, with Speaker Harvinder Kalyan suspending eight Congress MLAs for the remainder of the day's proceedings after repeated disruptions.

Those suspended were Induraj Narwal, Vikas Saharan, Devender Hans, Shakuntala Khatak, Aditya Surjewala, Balram Dangi, Gokul Setia and Jassi Petwar.

The session opened with Congress legislators, including Leader of Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda, wearing black and carrying placards as they sought to protest. Security personnel stopped them from taking the placards into the Assembly.

Under Rule 97(xi) of the Haryana Legislative Assembly Rules of Procedure and Conduct of



EIGHT CONG MLAS SUSPENDED FOR THE DAY

Business, 2024, members are barred from carrying placards or raising slogans inside the House.

The Opposition subsequently raised allegations of manhandling by security personnel, triggering heated exchanges and disrupting proceedings. Amid the uproar, the Speaker ordered the suspension of the eight legislators.

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Ahmedabad, August 27

Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah today advised young graduates to set the goals of their lives for the nation, society and the poor and not for themselves and their families, saying it would help them rise above failures and challenges in life.

Addressing the 72nd convocation of Gujarat Vidyapith in Ahmedabad as the chief guest, Shah said that approximately 900 students would receive their degrees and 11 gold medals and enter society at a crucial stage in their lives.

Talking about his association with Mahatma Gandhi's principles, Shah said that Gandhi's message was relevant and would continue to guide society for generations to come. He said that Gujarat Vidyapith, which had been founded by Gandhi on October 18, 1920, had been a laboratory for his thoughts on education, nationalism and



Union Home minister Amit Shah with students during 72nd convocation of Gujarat Vidyapith

social reforms.

The Home Minister said that the goal of education should be to build the 'nation' through the all-round development of the 'hands, heart and mind'. Education should equip one with skills, sensitivity, knowledge, wisdom and the ability to differentiate between right and wrong, he added.

He said that the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, which was based on mother tongue, skills, mul-

tidisciplinary learning, Indian knowledge systems and holistic development, reflected the basic principles of India's traditional system of education as well as modern innovations.

Shah asked the students to remember Mahatma Gandhi's seven social sins -- politics without principles, business without morality, wealth without labour, pleasure without conscience, knowledge without character, science without humanity and worship without

HE SAID THAT GUJARAT VIDYAPITH, WHICH HAD BEEN FOUNDED BY GANDHI ON OCTOBER 18, 1920, HAD BEEN A LABORATORY FOR HIS THOUGHTS ON EDUCATION, NATIONALISM AND SOCIAL REFORMS

sacrifice. The Minister said that Gandhi's 11 vows, which included non-violence, non-stealing, non-possession, physical labour, fearlessness, respect for all religions, Swadeshi and eradication of untouchability, were relevant even today.

The Union Home Minister said that Khadi was a symbol of the larger Swadeshi movement and the turnover of Khadi and Village Industries had increased from Rs 31,000 crore in 2013-14 to Rs 1.87 lakh crore in 2025-26.

Disaster in Nepal intensifies debate on climate risks

'Developments in the Himalayas should not be viewed as isolated incidents'

MPOST BUREAU
Dehradun, August 27

The recent flash flood disaster in Nepal has once again raised concerns over the changing Himalayan climate and the growing risks posed by melting glaciers, shifting precipitation patterns and debris flows in the region.

Manish Mehta, a scientist at the Wadia Institute of Himalayan Geology who has studied disasters including those in Kedarnath, Rishiganga and Dharali in Uttarakhand, said developments in the Himalayas should not be viewed as isolated



People move to a safer place after flash floods, in Devghat Bidur Municipality area, Nuwakot, Nepal, Thursday

incidents.

Rising temperatures are causing several Himalayan glaciers to retreat, leaving

behind large quantities of loose rocks, soil and debris. Unlike advancing glaciers that carry material

KEY POINTS

- » Rising temperatures are causing several Himalayan glaciers to retreat, leaving behind large quantities of loose rocks, soil and debris
- » Unlike advancing glaciers that carry material along their path, retreating glaciers expose unstable debris that can be washed or swept downhill during intense rainfall or rapid snowmelt

along their path, retreating glaciers expose unstable debris that can be washed or swept downhill during

intense rainfall or rapid snowmelt.

Mehta said scientists were also observing changes in precipitation at higher altitudes. Areas that traditionally received snowfall are increasingly witnessing rainfall, indicating that the snowfall zone is moving upwards while rainfall is reaching higher elevations.

When intense rain falls over a short period, loose debris can become saturated and suddenly move downhill, triggering landslides and debris flows. In some cases, snow and debris can temporarily block water channels,

creating natural barriers. Their sudden collapse can send large volumes of water, rocks and soil rushing downstream.

Such flash floods are therefore often far more destructive than ordinary floods because they carry heavy debris capable of damaging buildings, roads and bridges.

Mehta said landslides and debris flows were natural features of the Himalayas, a young and geologically active mountain range. However, climate change could intensify the risks associated with these phenomena.

EDITORIAL

Repeated Warnings

The catastrophic floods that have torn through Nepal are not merely another monsoon tragedy; they are a warning about how rapidly the Himalayan risk landscape is changing while institutions and infrastructure struggle to keep pace. The torrent that descended through the Bhote Koshi-Trishuli system swept away settlements, roads and bridges, damaged hydropower facilities and left hundreds dead or missing. The precise sequence that unleashed the disaster is still being reconstructed, but initial scientific assessments point to an enormous collapse of ice and rock that blocked a mountain river before the temporary barrier failed. That distinction matters. Nepal has always lived with earthquakes, landslides and violent rivers, but warming mountains are creating increasingly complex chains of hazards in which glaciers, unstable slopes, intense rainfall and fragile river valleys interact. The danger can therefore emerge far upstream and travel across borders with extraordinary speed. For a country whose roads, hydropower projects, tourism infrastructure and settlements frequently occupy narrow river corridors, treating such catastrophes as exceptional acts of nature is no longer defensible.

The deeper failure exposed by the disaster is one of preparedness. Early warning is useful only when information travels faster than the hazard. Questions have emerged over the timely exchange of upstream information between Nepal and China, even as authorities now confront the possibility of another temporary lake releasing water downstream. Nepal cannot move glaciers or widen Himalayan valleys, but it can reduce exposure. That requires continuous satellite surveillance of glaciers and unstable slopes, real-time river gauges, automatic alarms in vulnerable settlements and binding cross-border protocols for sharing hydrological and geological data. Equally important is a rethink of development itself. Roads carved into unstable slopes, bridges designed around historical flood assumptions, hydropower installations concentrated beside volatile rivers and settlements allowed to expand into hazard zones collectively convert extreme natural events into mass-casualty disasters. Nepal's repeated experience with earthquakes, landslides and floods should by now have produced a planning culture in which every major infrastructure project is subjected to climate and multi-hazard stress tests. Reconstruction after this flood must therefore resist the temptation to simply rebuild what existed before.

There is also a regional lesson. Himalayan disasters do not respect national boundaries. Rivers beginning in Tibet flow through Nepal into India, while the economic consequences of destroyed transport corridors, disrupted power generation and displaced communities travel even further. India's rapid mobilisation of humanitarian assistance and alerting of downstream states is necessary, but emergency solidarity must evolve into permanent regional risk cooperation. India, Nepal and China need dependable mechanisms for sharing upstream data, mapping dangerous glacial and landslide zones and coordinating warnings across borders. Climate adaptation in the Himalayas cannot remain a collection of national projects when the hazards themselves are transnational. For Nepal, the immediate task is rescue, relief and rehabilitation. The larger obligation begins once the waters recede: to investigate what failed, publish those findings and rebuild around the realities of a warmer, more unstable mountain system. The measure of this tragedy must ultimately be not only the lives it has taken, but the lives its lessons are allowed to save.

LETTER 
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Closed Doors

The worldwide pause on US immigrant visa applications creates needless uncertainty for thousands of families and skilled applicants. While governments have a legitimate interest in preventing misuse of public benefits, immigration decisions must remain individual and transparent. Blanket disruptions risk penalising genuine applicants and undermining confidence in America's legal immigration system.

SUMIT SACHDEVA,
BHOPAL

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

When the Rains Turn Ruinous

Recurring monsoon disasters expose India's inadequate preparedness, demanding stronger flood management, climate adaptation, resilient infrastructure and sustained investment

RESILIENCE ROADMAP



KDP RAO

THE WRITER IS A FORMER
ADDITIONAL CHIEF SECRETARY
OF CHHATTISGARH

Monsoons have always been romanticised by Indian cinema, celebrated with songs and dances since the rains bring life-giving water to the earth and the promise of a robust harvest. But the mayhem that the monsoons leave behind, and the hell that breaks loose on people and the economy, often spoil the fun. The monsoons have caused flash floods and landslides this year across many states, killing scores of people and uprooting thousands from their homes. According to the IFRC report (*Floods disaster in India, mitigation and their impacts*), 41% of all known disasters between 2008-2017 were flood-related, affecting over 730 million people.

A report by the World Meteorological Organisation (WMO) and the UN Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific (ESCAP) stated that India suffered a total loss of \$3.2 billion from flooding between June and September 2021. Such perpetual economic losses due to monsoons will not only slow down growth but also severely



Perpetual floods expose poor preparedness of government agencies and cities

reduce economic opportunities for marginalised classes, including daily-wage earners and migrant labourers, between June and October, not to mention the plight of small and marginal farmers pushed to the edge.

Climate change is worsening the problem through untimely rains, cloudbursts and flash floods as weather cycles have changed. While Mumbai has historically been notorious for monsoon deluges disrupting life and damaging property, cities like Delhi, Chennai and Hyderabad have also experienced severe floods. The social cost is huge, as floods not only rob the poor of their livelihoods but also affect educational institutions, healthcare systems, and road and rail communication for days.

The most common reasons for floods during monsoons are reduced river channel capacity due to sedimentation, alteration of the course of rivers due to encroachments, intense mining activity on riverbanks and deforestation. In urban areas, the problem is attributed to changes in land use and unplanned urbanisation blocking natural drainage systems (Chennai, Bangalore, Hyderabad). Additionally, poor

THE POLICY RESPONSE HAS CHIEFLY REMAINED REACTIVE RATHER THAN PREVENTIVE

drainage infrastructure, the collapse of flood-control structures and unscientific flood management exacerbate flood disasters.

The scenario of perpetual floods and disasters during monsoons points more to our faulty flood management than to natural weather factors. They expose the poor preparedness of government agencies and civic bodies. The policy response in India has chiefly been reactive rather than preventive. The World Bank's report (2023) states that policies are often siloed and insufficient for the scale of the problem. The gaps are significant. For example, only 349 (7%) Emergency Action Plans (EAPs) and 231 (5%) Operating Manuals (OPs) were prepared for 4,862 large dams by March 2016, with pre- and post-monsoon inspections fully con-

ducted in only 2 states, partially in 3, and not initiated in 12 out of 17 states/UTs.

The budget for flood control, adaptation and disaster management has been a concern for decades. According to PIB (21 Feb 2024), the Union Cabinet approved ₹4,100 crore for FMBAP for 2021-26, with ₹2,940 crore allocated to the Flood Management Programme (FMP) to support state governments in critical flood-control works like embankments, anti-erosion measures and drainage development. The allocations may appear robust but are insufficient given the scale of the problem in these times of climate change. We need huge investments in 'Adaptation' measures, including resilient structures, improved dry-land farming, resilient water infrastructure, multi-hazard early warning systems and nature-based solutions.

India needs to revisit its approach to flood management by observing the best models in the world. The Netherlands, with 67% of its land below mean sea level, is the global leader in flood management systems—a blend of hard engineering and sustainable nature-based solutions.

The "Room for the River" policy allows rivers space to expand during floods, reducing pressure on urban areas. The Maeslant barrier in Rotterdam, protecting the world's busiest port, is an engineering marvel. Integrated nature-based solutions are followed in the UK, such as creating floodplains and wetlands alongside traditional dikes and dams. The "Making Space for Water" initiative, Planning Policy Statement 25 (PPS25) and the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) integrate flood risk into urban planning in the United Kingdom.

The 1977 Comprehensive Flood Control Measures in Japan focus on integrated river basin management. Advanced flood-warning and evacuation contingency systems, including hazard maps and real-time monitoring, save lives and property in Japan. The United States provides flood insurance to property owners in flood-prone areas under the National Flood Insurance Program (NFIP, 1968). The Advanced Hydrologic Prediction System (AHPs) offers real-time flood forecasting with enhanced federal cooperation. China's "Sponge City" initiative in cities like Beijing, Tianjin, Wuhan and Shenzhen, begun in 2015-2016, aims to increase urban flood resilience through nature-based solutions like permeable surfaces, green roofs and restored wetlands. Similarly, the "Green Climate Screen" in Denmark is an innovative rainwater management system using natural processes to absorb and evaporate water while diverting excess water to green areas during heavy rainfall.

India needs effective flood-control models with liberal investments to permanently address the problem. A strict legal framework and effective enforcement are important to ensure proper compliance with environmental laws, not only on paper but also on the ground.

Views expressed are personal

Building Immunity from Birth

Evidence increasingly shows that breastfeeding shapes immunity, development and lifelong health

INFANT NUTRITION



PRIYANKA GUPTA BANSAL
& APARNA MUKHERJEE

BOTH WRITERS ARE SCIENTISTS
AT ICMR, NEW DELHI

Few health interventions have stood the test of time as convincingly as breastfeeding. Long before modern medicine understood immunity, nutrition or the gut microbiome, mothers were giving their babies the best possible start simply by breastfeeding.

World Breastfeeding Week, celebrated every year, is a reminder of one of the simplest, yet most effective ways to improve the health of mothers and children. Breastfeeding is often seen as a personal choice or a family practice, but its importance goes much beyond that. It is one of the earliest investments we can make in a child's health, with benefits that extend well beyond infancy.

In India, national surveys over the last decade show that exclusive breastfeeding during the first six months has remained in the range of about 55-65 per cent. Behind these numbers is an important question: what prevents moth-

ers from sustaining breastfeeding when they want to? Answering that question is just as important as measuring breastfeeding rates. This means that while many mothers are successfully breastfeeding their babies, there is still room to ensure that every mother who wishes to breastfeed receives the right support and encouragement.

Science has strengthened our understanding of why breastfeeding matters. Breast milk is uniquely designed for a growing baby. It not only provides all the nutrients an infant needs during the first six months of life, but also contains several protective factors that help the baby's developing immune system. Over the years, research has consistently shown that breastfed children are less likely to suffer from common infections in early life. Breastfeeding also supports healthy growth and brain development, and may help reduce the risk of obesity and other chronic diseases later in life. This evidence makes one point clear: breastfeeding is not simply a matter of personal preference; it is an important public-health intervention whose benefits extend well beyond the first months of life.

Interestingly, the benefits are not limited to children. Mothers who breastfeed also benefit from better recovery after childbirth and a lower risk of breast and ovarian cancers. At a broader level, healthier mothers and healthier children mean lower healthcare costs and a healthier society. Few health interventions offer such wide-ranging benefits for both generations.

At the same time, breastfeeding should never be seen as the responsibility of the mother alone. It is most successful when mothers receive timely guidance from



Breastfeeding is an early investment in child health

BREASTFEEDING BECOMES SUSTAINABLE WHEN MOTHERS RECEIVE SUPPORT FROM FAMILIES, WORKPLACES AND COMMUNITIES

healthcare providers and support from their families, workplaces and communities. Creating such an enabling environment is just as important as creating awareness.

India has shown strong commitment for supporting breastfeeding through national initiatives such as MAA (Mother's Absolute Affection) and by integration of breastfeeding counselling into maternal and child health services. Building on this, we now need to ensure that

every mother receives timely, evidence-based guidance and practical support through pregnancy and early months after childbirth.

While breastfeeding has been practised for generations, science continues to answer new questions. Researchers today are studying how breast milk influences the infant gut microbiome, how maternal nutrition affects milk composition, and how early feeding practices shape health later in

life. Such research helps refine recommendations and ensures that national policies remain based on the best available evidence.

Research supported by the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) has contributed to strengthening the evidence base on breastfeeding and newborn care in India. These studies have evaluated a range of interventions, including breastfeeding counselling and Kangaroo Mother Care, and have helped inform clinical practice and national efforts to promote optimal infant feeding. This evidence base is particularly relevant for India, where research can help translate global understanding into locally appropriate health practice.

More recently, an ICMR-supported systematic review and meta-analysis found that exclusive breastfeeding was associated with significantly lower odds of hospitalisation due to respiratory infections, particularly during the first year of life, further reinforcing the importance of exclusive breastfeeding for improving child health outcomes. Evidence such as this strengthens the case for moving beyond awareness campaigns towards systems that make evidence-based breastfeeding support a routine part of maternal and child healthcare.

As we celebrate World Breastfeeding Week, the message is straightforward. Breastfeeding is one of the best starts a child can receive, but mothers should not be expected to do it alone. They deserve accurate information, practical support and an environment that makes breastfeeding easier. That is an investment worth making, for every family and for the nation at large.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

PML-N names Barrister Iftikhar Gillani as PoK ‘PM’

LAHORE: Pakistan’s ruling PML-N supremo Nawaz Sharif has nominated Barrister Iftikhar Gillani for the so-called post of prime minister of Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK), a senior party leader said on Thursday.

The polls in the region’s so-called legislative assembly were held in three phases on July 27, August 2 and August 3 and were marred by violent protests and massive rigging allegations. The legislative assembly is likely to elect the prime minister on Friday.

Another ex-Malaysia PM faces criminal charges

KUALA LUMPUR: Malaysian former Prime Minister Ismail Sabri Yaakob was charged Thursday with failing to declare his assets, making him the nation’s third leader to face criminal charges after leaving office.

Ismail, 66, pleaded not guilty to a charge under the anti-graft law that alleged he failed to provide a complete declaration of assets following a notice from the anti-corruption agency in January 2025. The charge sheet lists large amounts of cash in Malaysian and foreign currencies.

Pakistan and Kuwait sign defence agreement

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan and Kuwait on Thursday signed an agreement to further strengthen bilateral defence cooperation, including in areas such as training, capacity building and border management.

The ‘Protocol Agreement-2026’ was signed during a meeting between Defence Minister Khawaja Asif and a Kuwaiti delegation led by Defence Minister Sheikh Abdullah Ali Al-Sabah in Rawalpindi. The delegation was accompanied by Kuwait Chief of General Staff of the Armed Forces.



View of the snow-capped Mount Kailash being seen during the Kailash Mansarovar pilgrimage, in Tibet’s Ngari

PTI

Briefs

Brazil sues Discord

SAO PAULO: Brazil’s government said on Wednesday it filed a lawsuit in a federal court against Discord, the popular platform for gamers to communicate online, seeking damages of 500 million reais (about USD 97 million) for the company’s alleged failure to protect children online.

The move comes in the wake of a July suicide case linked to the platform. Earlier this month, Brazil’s government pushed Discord to suspend its live broadcasts in relation to the incident.

The Solicitor-General’s office for President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva said in a statement the damages it is seeking from Discord are due to alleged collective psychological harm it has allowed.

US doesn’t need Canada: Trump

TORONTO: US President Donald Trump says his country does not need Canada. But every day, roughly 4 million barrels of Canadian crude oil flow south, helping fuel American cars, trucks and airplanes and supply US industry.

And oil is only the beginning. Canada also supplies aluminum, potash to U.S. farms and parts for an auto industry built on both sides of the border.

“WE DON’T NEED CANADA. THEY NEED US!” Trump posted this week, repeating his long-running claim.

Plane crashes near remote Alaska

ALASKA: A small plane carrying four people crashed into shallow waters next to a remote coastal town in Alaska on Wednesday, killing everyone on board, according to officials.

The Piper PA-24 was heading for the airport in the small town of Seldovia after taking off from Anchorage, according to a statement from the Alaska Department of Public Safety.

Seldovia’s airport is about 219 kilometres southwest of Anchorage.

After it crashed, it was submerged in about 15 feet of water in the Seldovia Slough near the shore, official said.

DEATH TOLL IN NEPAL FLASH FLOODS RISES TO 362

‘Nothing is left’: Eyewitnesses recall Nepal horror

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Kathmandu, August 27

Giri Lal has been left with memories of his wife and four children after Wednesday’s flash floods swept through Timure, a border town in Nepal’s Rasuwa district.

The 38-year-old was among those caught in a disaster that unfolded with such terrifying speed that, for many who witnessed it, it felt like an earthquake.

The flash floods took away Lal’s entire family - wife, two sons and two daughters. Lal, who drives a truck for the local waste management office, is now undergoing treatment at a state-run hospital in Kathmandu - around 160 km from Timure.

Death toll in Nepal flash floods rises to 362 on Thursday, as rescuers raced against time to find hundreds of people still missing in one of the country’s worst disasters in recent years. The flash floods struck parts of central Nepal on Wednesday



Relatives of individuals missing after a devastating flash flood wait near an army rescue camp as search and rescue operations continue, in Trishuli on Thursday

PTI

after an ice-rock avalanche upstream blocked the Lhende tributary of the Bhote Koshi River, sending a debris-laden surge downstream. It first hit Rasuwa, near the Nepal-Tibet border,

and eventually spread to other districts. “We have been showing their pictures to people and asking if anyone has seen them,” Lipa Sapkota said, standing outside the emergency section of Bharatpur Hospital

with a photograph of her brother, Sabi, missing since Wednesday morning. “There were some dead bodies, but they were not easy to identify because of their condition,” Sapkota told the Setopati.com.

Hundreds gather outside Nepal hospitals looking for loved ones

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Kathmandu, August 27

Hundreds of people gathered outside hospitals in Nepal on Thursday, searching for family members and friends who went missing in devastating flash floods that killed at least 359 people, as search operations continued at riverbanks and downstream areas for those still missing.

At Tribhuvan University Teaching Hospital in Maharajgunj, hundreds gathered to look for their relatives who had been out of contact since Wednesday, when the floods swept through Rasuwa and other parts of central Nepal before surging downstream along the Trishuli and Narayani river systems, The Kath-



People gather during a search and rescue operation in aftermath of the flash flood

PTI

mandu Post newspaper reported.

Many family members carried photos of their kin displayed on boards along with their addresses and mobile numbers, requesting peo-

ple to help trace them.

Authorities had posted lists of people brought to the hospitalso relatives could check whether their loved ones were among those rescued or receiving treatment.

Russia bombards nine Ukrainian cities overnight

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Kyiv, August 27

Russia bombarded cities across Ukraine with missiles and drones in an overnight onslaught that ran into the daylight hours Thursday, when explosions echoed around Kyiv through the morning.

Ukraine is desperately short of US-made Patriot air defence missiles that can counter Russia’s ballistic missiles, and Moscow’s fast-flying jet-powered drones have brought another challenge since the Russian military’s full-scale invasion began 4½ years ago.

Ukrainian officials say Russia builds up missile stocks and launches major attacks every few days, hoping to exhaust Ukrai-



nian defences through the sheer weight of numbers. In response, Ukraine has hit high-profile targets on Russian soil as the countries inflict mutual destruction.

The Russian Defence Ministry said its forces carried out a “massive” strike on targets in nine Ukrainian cities that began after nightfall on Wednesday. It described the targets as military-related, including industrial facilities, oil refineries, logistics hubs and port infrastructure.

Iran scrambles to sustain trade

As US threatens to sanction nations that refuse to break relations with the Islamic Republic

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Beirut, August 27

Iran’s economy, already strained by high inflation, years of Western sanctions and a war that has sharply reduced oil revenue, is poised for more instability as the Trump administration tries to coerce other countries into ending all financial dealings with the Islamic Republic.

A decision by the United Arab Emirates to suspend trade relations with Iran last week kick-started the White House’s latest attempt to isolate Tehran into submission.

Iran entered the war with its foreign commerce concentrated among a relatively small group of coun-



US President Donald Trump

tries, leaving it with fewer places to turn now.

The success of the US strategy will largely hinge on China, the main buyer of Iranian oil and its top trading partner. Russia, a fellow target of sweeping US-led sanctions, has a military conflict and economic crisis of its own and probably can’t offer longtime ally

Iran much hard financial support.

Regional partners like Turkiye, Pakistan and Iraq maintain important relationships with both Iran and the US, giving them reason to avoid exposure to the secondary sanctions that Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said awaited nations that did not cut economic ties with Iran.

“Those who stand with the United States will reap the rewards of our partnership,” Bessent said Monday while outlining the plan he called “Operation Economic Outcast.”

“Those who tether themselves to the Iranian regime should expect to share in the isolation.”

Chinese Premier Li visits flood-affected areas in Tibet

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Beijing, August 27

Chinese Premier Li Qiang on Thursday visited the Gyirong Township near the Nepal border post in Tibet, where 558 people were reported missing after a massive flash flood that caused heavy casualties.

The flash flood struck the Gyirong Township in the Tibet Autonomous Region on Wednesday morning. It swept through villages and towns near the China-Nepal border area, killing three in Tibet and 359 in Nepal, and leaving hundreds of others missing. State-run Xinhua news agency quoted local offi-

cials as saying that 558 people were reported missing in Tibet after a massive flash flood that caused heavy casualties.

The rescue work is hampered by a huge barrier lake, which Chinese officials, carrying out relief operations at the site, apprehend will cause a massive secondary disaster.

A team from China Anneng arrived in Gyirong County on Thursday with communications and detection equipment to collect key data and support efforts to address an upstream blockage or barrier lake, which is a top priority, Xinhua reported.

Parents, teachers in Congo urge delay of school resumption

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Bunia, August 27

Parents and teachers at the epicentre of Congo’s fast-moving Ebola outbreak are urging authorities to delay the reopening of schools as infections continue to outpace efforts to contain the disease.

The Ebola outbreak centred in the eastern Ituri province is the fastest-growing in the disease’s history and remains out of control with 5,713 confirmed cases, including 2,744 deaths, according to Congolese health authorities.

Schools are set to reopen across Congo on Sept. 1, but some teachers and parents in Ituri are urging authorities to delay the return, saying the Ebola outbreak still poses too great a risk to children.

Children aged 4 and below have the highest case-fatality rate of any age group in the outbreak, at 60 per cent, according to available health data.

“We want to resume classes, but not at the cost of our lives,” Fazila Rebecca, a teacher in Ituri’s capital of Bunia, told The Associated Press. “As

long as the disease is circulating and protective measures remain inadequate, returning to the classroom means taking a risk we cannot ignore.”

The local Ituri teachers union met Tuesday in Bunia, urging authorities to assess the outbreak before deciding whether to reopen schools.

“We are not opposed to the resumption of classes, but we believe that the health and safety of teachers and students must be a priority,” said Budju Lobo Isaac, a teachers’ union representative.

‘Israeli strikes kill three people in Gaza’

Over 1,300 Palestinians have been killed in Gaza since last October

AGENCIES

Cairo, August 27

Israeli strikes killed at least three Palestinians in the Gaza Strip on Thursday, health officials said.

Medics said an Israeli airstrike killed one person near Qarara town in the southern Gaza Strip, and another killed a man at a house in the Beach refugee camp in Gaza City.

Another airstrike on Gaza City later on Thursday hit a motorist, killing one person, they said.

The Israeli military did not immediately comment on any of the incidents.



Palestinians inspect the Abu Salim Mosque a day after it was hit by an Israeli airstrike

AP/PTI

An October 2025 U.S.-backed ceasefire halted major fighting in the shat-

tered territory, but it failed to end strikes by the Israeli military, which it said

aimed to thwart attacks by Hamas and other Gaza militants.

Hamas accuses Israel of violating the ceasefire and undermining efforts to implement a broader plan by U.S. President Donald Trump to end the Gaza conflict, which also includes Israeli withdrawals and Hamas disarmament.

More than 1,300 Palestinians have been killed in Gaza since the ceasefire took effect last October, according to Gazan health officials, while the Israeli military says four Israeli soldiers have been killed.

News at a glance

OYO parent Prism’s net profit rises 4-fold to ₹994 cr in FY26

NEW DELHI: IPO-bound Prism, the parent entity of OYO, on Thursday reported an over four-fold rise in net profit for FY26 to Rs 994 crore. The hospitality firm’s consolidated revenue from operations jumped 49.7 per cent to Rs 9,358 crore &z EBITDA more than doubled to Rs 2,594 crore in FY26. PRISM posted a net profit of Rs 245 crore in FY25. However, the FY26 net profit also included a Rs 678 crore deferred tax credit, the company’s annual report showed. The company paid interest of Rs 1,414 crore on its outstanding loan. IT seeks to raise up to Rs 6,650 crore through a fresh issue of equity shares.

‘India committed to conclude trade pact with Chile this year’

NEW DELHI: India is committed to concluding the ongoing negotiations for a trade pact with Chile this year, the Department of Commerce said on Thursday. Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agarwal is in Chile to review the progress of the negotiations. Agrawal, in his meeting with Paula Estevez Weinstein, Vice-Minister of International Economic Relations of Chile, emphasised the need to build on the strong India-Chile relationship and ensure that the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement translates shared ambitions into real opportunities for trade and investment.

TPREL commissions 72.5 MW solar project in Rajasthan

NEW DELHI: Tata Power’s subsidiary Tata Power Renewable Energy Limited (TPREL) on Thursday announced the commissioning of a 72.5-megawatt solar project at Bikaner in Rajasthan. The energy will be supplied to Tata Steel through TP Vardhman Surya, a subsidiary of Tata Power Renewable Energy Limited (TPREL), a statement said. TPREL said the ground-mounted project is expected to generate 166 MUs of green energy annually, and offset 1.18,856 tonnes of carbon emissions annually. The project deploys 1,71,360 modules for the Tata Steel project that have been manufactured from TP Solar Ltd.

Maharashtra tops statewide PV & CV sales in Q1: SIAM

NEW DELHI: Maharashtra recorded the highest passenger and commercial vehicle sales in Q1 FY27, while Uttar Pradesh topped two- and three-wheeler sales, according to SIAM data. India sold 12.74 lakh passenger vehicles, with Maharashtra accounting for 1,47,440 units. Of 2.65 lakh commercial vehicles sold, Maharashtra led with 36,433 units. Uttar Pradesh topped two-wheeler sales at 8,82,047 units out of 56.29 lakh nationally. It also led three-wheeler sales with 25,669 units, against 2.14 lakh units sold nationwide during April-June.

AMID GEOPOLITICAL DISRUPTIONS AND ENERGY CONCERNS GAIL plans major expansion in gas, petchems & clean energy: Chairman

OUR CORRESPONDENT New Delhi, August 27

State-run gas utility GAIL (India) Ltd plans to expand its natural gas pipeline network, diversify LNG sourcing and shipping, scale up petrochemicals and LPG infrastructure, and invest in clean-energy technologies as geopolitical disruptions underscore the need for greater energy security, the company’s Chairman & Managing Director Deepak Gupta said on Thursday. Addressing GAIL’s 42nd annual general meeting, Deepak Gupta said the year had highlighted the growing importance of balancing energy security with the global shift toward cleaner fuels. “Energy security has become as important as energy transition,” he said, pointing to geopolitical tensions in the Middle East and disruptions to LNG supply chains through the Strait of Hormuz that exposed vulnerabilities in global energy markets. “The resulting volatility in LNG prices, freight rates and supply availability reinforced the need for diversified sourcing, resilient infrastructure and flexible supply chains,” he said. “At the same time, the global transition towards cleaner energy continued



Deepak Gupta, GAIL (INDIA) LTD, Chairman and Managing Director

HE SAID THE YEAR HAD HIGHLIGHTED GROWING IMPORTANCE OF BALANCING ENERGY SECURITY WITH GLOBAL SHIFT TOWARD CLEANER FUELS

unabated, with sustained investments in renewable energy, nuclear power, energy storage and low-carbon technologies.” Natural gas, because of its flexibility and lower carbon intensity, would continue to play a role in the energy transition, he said. Gupta said the company’s pipeline network, already India’s largest natural gas transmission system, has expanded to more than 18,690 kilometres, with another 1,500 km under construction.

KEY POINTS

- » ‘Energy security has become as important as energy transition,’ Gupta said, pointing to geopolitical tensions in the Middle East and disruptions to LNG supply chains through the Strait of Hormuz
- » ‘The resulting volatility in LNG prices, freight rates and supply availability reinforced the need for diversified sourcing, resilient infrastructure and flexible supply chains,’ he said
- » The company is also progressing with its 500,000-tonne-a-year propane dehydrogenation-polypropylene project at Usar, which Gupta described as India’s first PDH-based polypropylene complex

Once those projects are completed, the network is expected to approach 20,000 km. GAIL is simultaneously expanding its LPG transmission business. The company is doubling the capacity of its 1,427-km Jamnagar-Loni LPG pipeline to 6.5 MMTPA from 3.25 MMTPA. The Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board has also authorised GAIL to develop three LPG pipelines with a combined length of about 1,775 km.

In petrochemicals, GAIL commissioned a 60,000-tonne-a-year polypropylene unit at Pata, raising the integrated complex’s capacity to 870,000 tonnes from 810,000 tonnes. The company is also progressing with its 500,000-tonne-a-year propane dehydrogenation-polypropylene project at Usar, which Gupta described as India’s first PDH-based polypropylene complex. At Mangalore, work is progressing on a 1.25 MMTPA purified terephthalic acid (PTA) plant, giving GAIL an entry into another petrochemical value chain. “These investments in petrochemicals are not simply about adding capacity,” he said. “They are about developing a more diversified downstream business and strengthening the growth of GAIL’s petrochemical portfolio.” GAIL is also moving into large-scale gas-based fertiliser manufacturing. Its board has given in-principle approval for investments in two fertiliser plants in Maharashtra and Chhattisgarh, with combined investment of about

Rs 21,000 crore. The projects are expected to create additional demand for natural gas and support regional development while contributing to India’s food-security objectives. Gupta said GAIL’s LNG sourcing portfolio stands at 16.56 million tonnes a year (MMTPA), combining long-term contracts with market-linked procurement. The company imported 132 LNG cargoes during fiscal 2025-26, including seven spot cargoes, as it sought to maintain supplies to priority customers amid volatility in international markets. GAIL has also expanded its shipping capabilities, concluding long-term charter agreements for the GAIL Bhuwan, with a capacity of 180,000 cubic metres, and Energy Fidelity, with capacity of 174,000 cubic metres, he said, adding that the company now has access to nine LNG vessels, including five under long-term charter arrangements, according to the chairman. Its overseas operations are also being expanded. GAIL Global (USA) LNG LLC supports the company’s US sourcing and liquefaction portfolio, while GAIL Global (Singapore) Pte Ltd is developing LNG trading and international business.

OUR CORRESPONDENT New Delhi, August 27

Bharat Petroleum Corp Ltd (BPCL), India’s second largest fuel retailer, on Thursday said there is no decision to replace E20 petrol with E10, clarifying that the current debate is over whether older vehicles should have access to a lower-ethanol blend and how an additional grade of petrol could be supplied across India’s vast fuel-distribution network. In a media call post the company’s annual shareholder meeting, BPCL Chairman and Managing Director Sanjay Khanna, however, said he saw no operational or logistical challenge in switching from E20 petrol to E10 if the government decides to change the ethanol-blending policy. “I never said that E20 will be changed to E10,” he said, adding that it was being debated in some circles whether older vehicles should have an option of lower-ethanol blend fuel. “That doesn’t mean E20 will be out and E10 will be in,” he said. His comments come amid a wider policy discussion over whether owners of older vehicles should have access to E10 petrol, which contains 10 per cent ethanol, alongside E20, which contains 20 per cent ethanol. India has progressively increased ethanol blend-



ing in petrol as part of efforts to reduce crude oil imports, lower emissions and support domestic ethanol production. Khanna stressed that no decision has been finalised on changing the current fuel-blending regime. “Nothing has been finalised,” he said. “But to answer your question, what if it happens or what are the changes required? I will say nothing because already we established E20. It’s only a matter of changing from E20 to E10, or suppose it has to be done. On that account, we don’t see as a company any challenge for that matter. None of the oil companies will have a challenge to go from E20 to E10.” It is being debated whether India should make E10 petrol, which contains 10 per cent ethanol, available alongside E20 fuel, following concerns raised by some consumers and industry stakeholders about the impact of higher ethanol blends on vehicles and fuel availability.

“As of now, various aspects are being considered, but nothing has yet got finalised. Once it will be done, we’ll be definitely calling you and sharing it with you,” he said. Asked what changes oil companies would need to make if E10 were introduced, he said the existing infrastructure would not pose a major hurdle. The distinction, however, is between switching the blend and supplying an additional grade of petrol alongside E20. The latter presents a more significant logistical challenge, particularly given the scale of India’s fuel-distribution network. Earlier this month, the government’s Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran, alongside Akash Poojari, who is a consultant in the Department of Economic Affairs, in an opinion piece, stated that India should bring back a petrol variant with a lower ethanol blend to protect millions of older vehicles.

Prudential Plc sells 2% stake in ICICI Pru AMC for ₹3,030 crore

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA New Delhi, August 27

Hong Kong-based Prudential plc on Thursday completed the sale of a 2 per cent stake in ICICI Prudential Asset Management Company (AMC) for Rs 3,030 crore through an open market transaction. Prudential, through its subsidiary Prudential Corporation Holdings Ltd, sold 98,85,169 shares, representing a 1.99 per cent stake in Mumbai-based ICICI Prudential AMC, according to bulk deal data on the BSE. The shares were disposed of at an average price of Rs 3,065.47 apiece, taking the transaction value to Rs 3,030.27 crore. After the latest transaction, Prudential Corporation Holdings will retain a 32.6 per cent stake in ICICI Prudential Asset Management Company Ltd. The combined holding of promoters and promoter group entities in ICICI Prudential AMC declined to 85.61 per cent from 87.60 per cent. Details of the buyers of ICICI AMC’s shares could not be identified on the BSE. ICICI Prudential AMC’s shares declined 4.06 per cent to close at Rs 3,092.65 apiece on the NSE.

BIS fast-tracks HUID based silver hallmarking ahead of festive season

MPOST BUREAU New Delhi, August 27

The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS), under the Department of Consumer Affairs, has expanded the HUID-based silver hall-marking ecosystem ahead of the festive season, with 341 Silver Assaying & Hall-marking Centres across 102 districts and more than 25,000 registered silver jewellers. Since the Silver HUID portal was launched on September 1, 2025, over 77

lakh silver jewellery pieces have been hallmarked with the six-digit alphanumeric HUID. Purity grades 925 and 800 account for nearly 95 per cent of hall-marked items. The Southern Region leads with 62 per cent, followed by Western at 18 per cent and Central at 10 per cent. A BIS market survey covering 4,971 responses across 30 States and Union Territories found that 10-25 gram and 25-50 gram articles together account for nearly 74 per cent of

demand. Anklets, chains, toe rings, finger rings and bracelets are among the most commonly sold items, with 925 and 800 ppt being the most popular grades. BIS advised consumers to buy hallmarked silver from registered jewellers, verify HUID details through the BIS CARE app and retain invoices. Complaints regarding discrepancies or misuse can also be lodged through the BIS CARE app or website.

‘Russian oil disruption may challenge refiners’

AGENCIES New Delhi, August 27

A possible disruption to Russian oil supplies, coupled with continued pressure around the Strait of Hormuz, could pose a “huge challenge” for Indian oil companies to secure crude and meet domestic fuel demand, BPCL Chairman & MD Sanjay Khanna said on Thursday. “Today, all the companies are procuring in the range of 35 to 45 per cent Russian oil and, you know, making a ban on that quantity and with the Strait of Hormuz under pressure,



BPCL, Chairman & MD, Sanjay Khanna

definitely it will be a huge challenge for oil companies to get the crude and cater to the national demand,” Khanna said at BPCL’s Post AGM Virtual Press Conference. His comments come

amid uncertainty over India’s Russian crude purchases following US moves to tighten sanctions on buyers of Russian energy. The US Senate in early August passed the Russia Sanctions Bill, which could impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on top countries, including India and China, purchasing Russian crude oil and natural gas. Khanna said BPCL was assessing the situation and exploring alternative crude sources across “every possible geography”. “It is a very uncertain situation. Nobody knows how it will unfold next week,” he said.

He said BPCL’s crude and LPG supplies were currently in place, supported by diversified sourcing, but cautioned that the situation could change with geopolitical developments. The company has expanded sourcing from countries including Venezuela and Angola. BPCL recorded consolidated capital expenditure of Rs 21,372 crore in FY26. It reported a net loss of Rs 3,962 crore in the June quarter, against a net profit of Rs 3,191 crore in the March quarter. Revenue rose 27.5 per cent sequentially to Rs 1.51 lakh crore.

‘No changes in CAS, final nod on NSE IPO soon’

‘We are not seeing any changes to CAS right now, system running as it is’

AGENCIES Mumbai, August 27

Sebi Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey on Thursday said the regulator has no plans to change the newly introduced closing auction session (CAS), while indicating that the NSE’s IPO approval is nearing. “We are not seeing any changes right now to CAS, and the system is running as it is. Participation will increase and everyone, brokers, will enable it in their apps,” Pandey said on the



Sebi Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey

sidelines of the 30th Anniversary Celebration of NSE Clearing. Introduced on August 3, CAS pools buy and sell orders during a designated window near the end of

CLOSER LOOK

- » ‘Sebi’s ability to detect manipulation under CAS is higher than under the earlier volume-weighted average price system’
- » Pandey said Sebi was ‘very close’ to approving its Draft Red Herring Prospectus, clearing the way for the NSE’s public issue
- » The Sebi chairman added that Sebi would assess any proposal from NSE to allow its shares to trade on its own platform

trading for auction-style matching, aimed at improving transparency and curbing manipulation. Pandey said Sebi’s ability to detect manipulation under CAS is higher than under the ear-

lier volume-weighted average price (VWAP) system. On NSE’s IPO, Pandey said Sebi was “very close” to approving its Draft Red Herring Prospectus (DRHP), clearing the way for the

equity exchange’s public issue. He added that Sebi would assess any proposal from NSE to allow its shares to trade on its own platform. Pandey also called for a shift from measuring risks to anticipating them, highlighting interconnected financial institutions, technology failures and liquidity shocks as key concerns. “Risk can no longer be understood only by looking at individual institutions. We must also understand the relationships between them,” he said.

India & Canada working to ease remittances: FM

AGENCIES Washington, August 27

India and Canada are working to facilitate easier cross-border remittances, a move that could benefit over four lakh Indian students studying in Canada. “We are talking; our teams are going to be talking further, and adopting everything which helps in easier payment, cross-border remittances,” Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said after the inaugural Economic and Financial Dialogue with Canadian Finance Minister Francois-Philippe Champagne

in Toronto. Champagne said financial services offer significant growth opportunities between the two countries and highlighted the need to facilitate payments for around 400,000 Indian students. He said remittances could be around 45,000 Canadian dollars per student, adding that easier transfers would provide greater peace of mind to parents in India. Both sides also discussed greater cooperation in digital payments and increasing the presence of financial institutions in each other’s markets.

NUMBER OF ACCOUNTS CROSS 59 CR WITH ₹3.17L CR DEPOSITS

PM Jan Dhan scheme marks 12 yrs

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 27

Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY), the government's flagship financial inclusion scheme, has completed 12 years, with the number of bank accounts under the scheme crossing 59 crore and deposits at Rs 3.17 lakh crore, the Finance Ministry said on Thursday.

The scheme, launched on August 28, 2014 by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, is providing banking and financial services to unbanked and economically disadvantaged sections, with 78 per cent of PMJDY accounts opened in rural and semi-urban areas and around 56 per cent held by women.

The average deposit per account is Rs 5,356 as on August 19, 2026, and the average deposit per account has increased 3.4 times in the last 12 years, the finance ministry said in a statement.

The increase in the average deposit is another indication of the increased usage of accounts and the inculcation of saving habits among account holders, it said.

Speaking on the anniver-



THE INCREASE IN THE AVERAGE DEPOSIT IS ANOTHER INDICATION OF THE INCREASED USAGE OF ACCOUNTS AND THE INCULCATION OF SAVING HABITS AMONG ACCOUNT HOLDERS

sary, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said the success of PMJDY should not be viewed merely in terms of the number of accounts opened, but in its transformation of the country's banking and financial landscape.

PMJDY has empowered millions, particularly the marginalised sections, to access banking and financial services to improve their socio-economic conditions, he said.

"Account ownership has enabled the common

man to have insurance and pension coverage. Through relentless saturation drives across every state and district, we have moved towards near-universal coverage of bank accounts and steadily widened the reach of insurance and pension schemes to those who need them most," he said.

Chaudhary also appreciated the efforts of bankers and business correspondents deployed across the country for taking the PMJDY scheme to the common man and contributing

KEY POINTS

» The avg deposit per account is Rs 5,356 as on August 19, 2026 and average deposit per account has increased 3.4 times in last 12 years

» PMJDY has empowered millions, particularly the marginalised sections, to access banking and financial services, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said

» As many as 41.29 crore RuPay cards have been issued to PMJDY account holders, and the number and usage of RuPay cards have increased over time

to its success.

The Jan-Dhan-Aadhaar-Mobile (JAM) trinity, with PMJDY at its core, has proven to be a diversion-proof mechanism for the direct delivery of financial assistance, the ministry said.

Through JAM, the government has successfully transferred welfare benefits directly into the bank accounts of the underprivileged, eliminating intermediaries and delays, it added.

Under PMJDY, eligible account holders get a basic

bank account without any minimum balance requirement or maintenance charges. The accounts are also linked with free RuPay debit cards, which provide accident insurance cover of up to Rs 2 lakh.

As many as 41.29 crore RuPay cards have been issued to PMJDY account holders, and the number and usage of RuPay cards have increased over time, it said.

Account holders are also eligible for an overdraft facility of up to Rs 10,000, providing financial support during emergencies, the ministry said.

With visible saving patterns, account holders are now eligible for loans, including MUDRA loans, empowering individuals to grow their incomes and build financial resilience, it said.

The ministry said PMJDY accounts have also helped extend insurance and pension coverage to millions, particularly workers in the unorganised sector, through the government's Jan Suraksha schemes -- Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana and Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana.

Goyal calls for faster FDI flows via streamlined processes, procedures

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Osaka, August 27

Improvements in processes and procedures, more efficient KYC norms, and streamlined approvals will facilitate a faster flow of foreign direct investment (FDI) and provide greater comfort to investors, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Thursday.

There are very few sectors where foreign direct investment (FDI) is restricted, and the government is open to ideas from industry to further improve the investment regime, he said.

"Our focus is on process and procedures...There is a tremendous scope to improve processes and procedures, to help faster flow of FDI and to help give comfort to the investors," Goyal said when asked if the government is considering a proposal to promote ease of doing business for foreign investors.

On how the government can streamline processes, he said wherever investments need DPIIT or government approvals, processes can be streamlined to make them faster.

"We can have faster and more efficient KYC (know your customer) norms; we



Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal

THERE ARE VERY FEW SECTORS WHERE FDI IS RESTRICTED, AND THE GOVERNMENT IS OPEN TO IDEAS FROM INDUSTRY, HE SAID

can have MRAs (mutual recognition agreements) with regulators in other countries which respect each other's approvals," he added.

Several new ideas have emerged during engagements with industry and stakeholders in Japan, he noted. "It will be a continuous process where we take ideas, do stakeholder engagements and continue to improve," Goyal said.

India allows 100 per cent FDI under the automatic route in most sectors, while certain sensitive sectors and activities have

restrictions or require government approval.

The government is considering a proposal to raise the threshold for foreign direct investment proposals requiring approval from the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs to Rs 15,000 crore from Rs 5,000 crore at present to further improve the country's investment climate.

It is also mulling a proposal to ease FDI norms for downstream investments to boost overseas fund inflows.

FDI into India rose by 17 per cent to \$94.5 billion in 2025-26.

When asked if Japan is suggesting India join the 12-member bloc Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership (CPTPP), the minister said a lot of people are asking India to consider this suggestion.

"But we have not yet really applied our mind (to it)," he said. He added that India's focus is on bilateral trade pacts.

India at present is negotiating trade pacts with countries and groups, including Israel, Chile, Peru, Canada, GCC (Gulf Cooperation Council), Russia-led EAEU, and SACU (South African Customs Union).

Briefs

Rupee falls 1 paisa to 95.45/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee pared initial gains and settled for the day lower by 1 paise at 95.45 against the US dollar on Thursday, on a strong American currency and weak domestic markets.

At interbank forex, rupee opened at 95.50, and traded in range of 95.40-95.56. It finally settled for the day at 95.45 against the greenback, lower by 1 paise from its previous close.

ICICI Pru MF hikes SBI Card Stake

NEW DELHI: ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund has increased its stake in SBI Card to 7.3 per cent by acquiring additional shares from the open market, the credit card firm said on Thursday.

The fund house has carried out the acquisition of 21,60,916 shares on August 25 through the open market, SBI Card said. As a result, the shareholding of the fund house rose by 2.12 per cent from 5.18 per cent, the credit card arm of SBI added.

S&P Global Ratings retains India's sovereign rating at 'BBB'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, August 27

S&P Global Ratings on Thursday retained India's sovereign rating at 'BBB' with a stable outlook, saying India is a dynamic and fast-growing economy with policy predictability.

S&P said high energy prices and challenging agricultural conditions will marginally slow India's growth this year, but economic fundamentals are expected to remain sound and support robust growth over the next two to three years.

"The sovereign credit ratings on India are

anchored by a dynamic and fast-growing economy, strong external balance sheet, and stable institutions that support policy predictability," S&P said while affirming its 'BBB' long-term and 'A-2' short-term unsolicited sovereign credit ratings on India.

The outlook on the long-term rating is stable.

The 'BBB' is the lowest investment-grade rating.

Counterbalancing the strengths are the government's weak fiscal performance and burdensome debt stock, as well as low GDP per capita, the US-based agency said.

The stable outlook

reflects S&P's view that continued policy stability and high infrastructure investment will support India's long-term growth prospects.

The growth outlook, along with stable fiscal and monetary policies that moderate the government's elevated debt and interest burden, will underpin the rating over the next 24 months, it added.

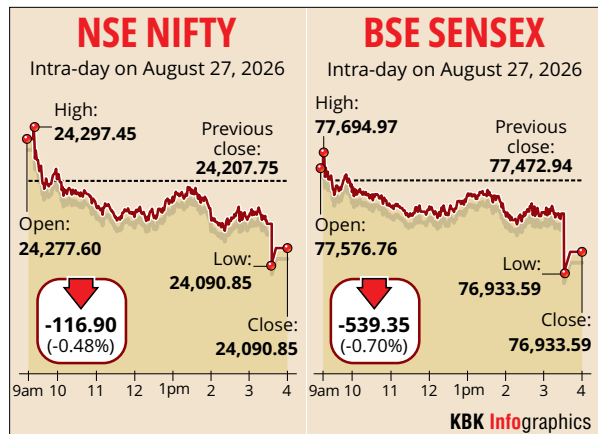
India remains among the best-performing economies in the world, with an average annual growth of 7.9 per cent in the last five years, from fiscal 2022 (year-ended March 31, 2022) to fiscal 2026.

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, August 27

Stock markets declined for the second consecutive day on Thursday, with the benchmark Sensex dropping by 539 points due to last-minute selling in blue-chip shares such as HDFC Bank and Reliance Industries.

The 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 539.35 points, or 0.70 per cent, to settle at the day's low of 76,933.59. Similarly, the 50-share NSE Nifty declined 116.90 points, or 0.48 per cent, to end at the day's low of 24,090.85.

HDFC Bank was the big-



gest loser among 30 Sensex firms, dropping by 2.08 per cent following news of a US class-action lawsuit. Reliance Industries fell by 1 per

cent, dragging the index down. Bharti Airtel, NTPC, M&M, HCL Tech and ITC were also among major laggards. Kotak Mahindra

Bank, ICICI Bank, Tech Mahindra and Bharat Electronics were among the winners.

The BSE MidCap Select index declined 0.47 per cent, while SmallCap Select Index ended largely flat, up 0.01 per cent.

Among BSE sectoral indices, MidSmall Pvt Banks tanked the most by 2.57 per cent, followed by MidSmall Pvt Banks Quality Tilt (2.41 per cent), PSU Bank (2.12 per cent), Bankex (1.67 per cent), Pvt Banks index (1.19 per cent) and Top 10 Banks (1.07 per cent).

Capital Goods, Telecom, Healthcare and Industrials were the winners.

NTPC aims 244 GW capacity by 2037: Chairman

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 27

NTPC aims to expand its operating capacity to 244 GW by 2037 and plans cumulative capital expenditure of Rs 16.86 lakh crore as it seeks to strengthen its presence across the energy value chain, Chairman Gurdeep Singh said on Thursday.

Addressing shareholders at the company's 50th Annual General Meeting (AGM), Singh said the next decade will be among the most significant growth periods in NTPC's history, driven by rising electricity demand as India's econ-

omy expands and living standards improve.

"We have raised our long-term capacity ambitions and now target generating capacity of 149 GW by 2032, including 60 GW of renewable energy, with an aspiration to reach 244 GW by 2037 excluding storage," Singh said. NTPC currently has around 91 GW of capacity.

The company expects to invest around Rs 16.86 lakh crore up to FY37 across thermal, hydro and pumped storage, renewables, battery storage, mining and nuclear.

Singh described it as one of the largest invest-

ment programmes undertaken by an Indian power utility.

On nuclear energy, Singh said NTPC aims to secure a 30 per cent share in the government's ambitious 100 GW nuclear capacity target by 2047 under the Nuclear Energy Mission.

NTPC is developing a 2.8 GW nuclear project in Rajasthan with NPCIL and is studying additional projects at 34 sites across 13 states.

"Nuclear power will complement both renewable and thermal generation by providing reliable, low-carbon, round-the-

clock electricity," the chairman said.

Singh also said NTPC's Coal Gasification-based Synthetic Natural Gas Project, with a capacity of 5.75 lakh tonnes per annum, is progressing well.

Once established, it will be India's first plant of its kind and directly substitute imported natural gas.

NTPC Group posted its highest-ever consolidated Profit After Tax (PAT) of Rs 27,546 crore in FY26, up 15 per cent from the previous year.

Group EBITDA rose to Rs 60,564 crore, while net worth increased to around Rs 2.03 lakh crore.

Sembcorp Green Infra Ltd files papers for its ₹3,750 crore IPO

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 27

Sembcorp Green Infra Ltd, the Indian renewable energy arm of Temasek-backed Sembcorp Industries, has filed preliminary papers with Sebi to raise up to Rs 3,750 crore through an IPO with proceeds to be used for payment of debt.

The proposed IPO is entirely a fresh issue of equity shares with no Offer For Sale (OFS) component.

The IPO proceeds will be used for payment of

certain borrowings by the company and the subsidiaries, according to the Draft Red Herring Prospectus filed on Wednesday.

The proposed capital raise will help strengthen its balance sheet as it scales up its renewable energy portfolio. Sembcorp Green Infra had 3.60 GW of operational renewable energy capacity and about 4.04 GW/GWh under construction as of March 31, 2026.

Its under-construction portfolio includes 2.61 GW of renewable energy

capacity and 1,433 MWh of battery energy storage system (BESS) capacity.

The company is also increasing its focus on complex renewable projects, including hybrid, storage-backed, Round-the-Clock (RTC) and Firm and Dispatchable Renewable Energy (FDRE) projects. Axis Capital, Citigroup, CLSA, HSBC, ICICI Securities, IIFL Capital Services and Kotak Mahindra Capital have been appointed as book-running lead managers to the issue.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



State Bank of India (SBI) donated three golf carts to IIM Calcutta on August 25, 2026. Present were Prof. Alok Kumar Rai, Director, IIM Calcutta; Prof. Vivek Rajvanshi, Dean (Development & External Relations), IIM Calcutta; Naveen Kumar Gupta, GM, Network-II, LHO Kolkata, SBI; Mukul Kumar Singh Manna, Deputy GM (Business & Operations), SBI and Amrita Patnaik, Regional Manager, Region 5, AO South 24 Parganas, SBI.



The National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development and the National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD) signed an MoU to facilitate joint financing opportunities for rural infrastructure projects across India. The MoU was signed in the presence of Dr Shaji Krishnan V, Chairman, NABARD; Rajkiran Rai G, MD, National Bank for Financing Infrastructure & Development and Monika Kalra, Deputy MD - CFO National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development.

Retail prices of sugar fall to ₹64.33/kg

Retail prices remained high despite 20% fall in ex-mill rates

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 27

Sugar prices eased marginally on Thursday to Rs 64.33 per kg in the retail market following the government's measures to allow imports, imposition of stockholding curbs and crackdown on hoarders.

As per data compiled by the Department of Consumer Affairs, the all-India average rate of sugar is ruling at Rs 64.33 per kg on Thursday, a marginal drop from Rs 65.05 per kg on

CLOSER LOOK

» The current average price of sugar is 31 per cent higher than the month-ago level and 39 per cent higher than the year-ago prices

» The data showed that the maximum selling price on Thursday was Rs 76 per kg, while the modal rate was Rs 65 per kg

August 26.

Retail prices of the sweetener remained high despite a nearly 20 per cent decline in ex-mill rates after the government's decision to allow duty-free imports of 10 lakh tonnes of raw sugar.

The current average price of sugar is 31 per cent higher than the month-ago level and 39 per cent higher than the year-ago prices.

The data showed that the maximum selling price on Thursday was Rs 76 per

kg, while the modal rate was Rs 65 per kg.

In a statement on Thursday, Indian Sugar & Bio-energy Manufacturers Association (ISMA) said, "Sugar prices have corrected by nearly 20 per cent from recent highs, with supply-side measures and improved market visibility beginning to reflect in the market. The correction is expected to continue as festive buying normalises and fresh sugar becomes available over the coming weeks".

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
No:- 128-W/Sr.DEN-C/NIT-07-26-27/WC Dated: 27.08.2026
The Divisional Track, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work.
Invitation of tender through E- Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

1 Name of work with its location	Complete job of IN-SITU reconditioning of 559 Nos. WCMS/CMS crossings by using technology of Robotic welder in identified yards over Delhi Division. (NIT-07-26-27-WC)
2 Approx cost of work	Rs. 3,55,38,654.19/-
3 Earnest money	Rs. 7,10,800.00/-
4 Date and Starting time for filling e-tender & Tender opening time	Starting time for filling e-tender is Date - 04.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. & Tender opening time is Date - 18.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
5 Website particulars, published e-tender, notice location etc. complete details of tender can be seen and web site where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE
2966/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA
Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Hussen Mubarak S/o Md. Aabi R/o Jhuggi No. F-176, Shahbad Dairy, Delhi**, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No.10/2022 U/s 392/511/34 IPC.**, has been registered at **PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Hussen Mubarak** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Hussen Mubarak** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Hussen Mubarak** of under **FIR No.10/2022 U/s 392/511/34 IPC.**, Registered at: **PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **12.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Banwal
Ld. JMFC
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/12053/ON/2026
(Court Notice)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Notice No. 2026-Aug-04 Dated - 25.08.2026

E-Tender Notice
Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N.C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under :
Tender No.: 2026-Aug-04-01 Approx Cost Rs.: 10268691.96
Description of Work : Composite tender (Civil + Electrical) work for Extension of Existing RPF Office building of Divisional Quarter Master, Train Escorting (Admin Post), Public Prosecutor and SIB office at AGC.
Tender No.: 2026-Aug-04-02 Approx Cost Rs.: 12828574.45
Description of Work : Improvement to colony road, approach road to RCC OHT & RPF barrack & mehlab bagh to qtr no. 14/T at JAB under jurisdiction of SSE/WDH under ADEN/HA/AGC.
Tender No.: 2026-Aug-04-03 Approx Cost Rs.: 34259264.38
Description of Work : Composite tender (Civil+Electrical) work for (i) Provision of New Parcel office at Idgah Railway station (ii) Development of infrastructure facilities for enroute train examination at IDH station
Tender No.: 2026-Aug-04-04 Approx Cost Rs.: 21003521.52
Description of Work : (A) Provision of Toolboxes with Rest rooms for each Gang/Units under SSE/P. Way/AA under ADEN/HQ/AGRA (B) Provision of Toolboxes with Rest rooms for each Gang/Units under SSE/PW/IN/AGC under ADEN/Line/IDH.
For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in" Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" upto 15.00 hrs on 14.09.26 1990/26 (C)
North central railways @www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Deepak @ Chhotu @ Kaliya S/o Manoj Paswan R/o Jhuggi Sector-26, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 01/2019 u/s 25/54/59 Arms Act at P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the above said **Deepak @ Chhotu @ Kaliya** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the above said **Deepak @ Chhotu @ Kaliya** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Deepak @ Chhotu @ Kaliya** accused of **FIR No. 01/2019 u/s 25/54/59 Arms Act at P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.10.2026**.

By Order: **Ms. Bharti Beniwai,**
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-05 (North),
Court No. 114, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi.

DP/12059/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Gopal @ Vijay @ Kallu S/o Harbans Lal R/o Jhuggi No. C-25, Jawalapur Camp No. 4, Delhi** also at H. No. 16/756, Gali No. 9, Military Road, Bapanagar, Karol Bagh, New Delhi has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 103/2024 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Tilak Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Gopal @ Vijay @ Kallu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Gopal @ Vijay @ Kallu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Gopal @ Vijay @ Kallu** of case **FIR No. 103/2024 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Tilak Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vikas Madaan
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Room No. 289
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12001/WD/2026 (Court Matter)

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF Sh. Mohammad Saeer
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Rohtak
Suresh widow daughter of Lt. Sh. Hukam Chand and wife of Lt. Sh. Karambir
Vs.
General Public
CNR No. HRRH02-001436-2026
Next Date 08-10-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
General Public
- India
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **08-10-2026 at 10:00 am.**
For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?trs=districtnotice&district=Rohtak>
Sd/- **Sh. Mohammad Saeer**
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division),
dated 27.08.2026 **Rohtak**

Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER PMGSY (JKRRDA) JAMMU.
NOTICE INVITING E-TENDERS
e-NIT No:-CEJ/PMGSY/838 of 2026-27 Dated:- 25/08/2026

Chief Engineer PMGSY (JKRRDA) Jammu on behalf of The Government of Jammu & Kashmir, invites e-tenders on %age Above/Excess (+) OR %age Below / Less (-) basis (i.e. on Percentage-Rate Basis) from approved and eligible Contractors registered with J&K U.T.Govt, CPWD, Railways or equivalent and other State/U.T.Govts up to 1700 Hrs. on 12-09-2025 for each of the following works.

Sr. No.	Name of Work/ Package No.	Name of the PIU	Const. Part (Rs. In Lacs)	Maint. Part (Rs. In Lacs)	Total (Rs. In Lacs)	Cost of Documents (Rs. In Lacs)	Bid Security (EMD) @2% of total cost rounded to the nearest thousand (Rs. In Lacs)	Time Allowed for completion	Call of tender	Time and date of opening of technical bids	Class of Contractor
1	Construction of double lane steel truss girder Bridge 3 X 30 M span on road NH1A Km 55th to Surara, Package No JK07-WB-01 at RD 5.575 to 5.675	Kathua	1329.05	106.32	1435.37	0.20	28.71	15 Months	1"	15-09-2026 1100 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works

Date and Time Schedule

S.No	Particulars	Date	Time	
1	Date of issue of tender notice	25-08-2026	1700 hrs	
2	Document Download / Sale Start Date	27-08-2026	1855 hrs	
3	Pre-Bid Meeting	31-08-2026	1200 hrs	
4	Bid submission start date	01-09-2026	1000 hrs	
5	Bid submission end date	12-09-2026	1700 hrs	
6	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bids	15-09-2026	1100 hrs	
7	Date & Time of Opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical evaluation is completed		To be notified after technical evaluation is completed

1. The bidding document can be downloaded from the website and bids shall be submitted ONLINE ONLY in electronic format through the e-tendering portal.

2. For complete details and instructions, bidders are advised to refer to Standard bidding document(SBD).

3. For further details and updates, bidders may visit the official website <https://pmgsytendersjk.gov.in>

No:-CEJ/PMGSY/17520-94
Dated:-25-08-2026
DIP No:DIP/J-8880/26

Sd/-Chief Engineer PMGSY (JKRRDA) Jammu
For and on behalf of The Government of Jammu and Kashmir

**JHARKHAND BIJLI VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED**
(CIN: U40108JH2013SGC001702)
Regd. Office:- Engineering Building, HEC, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004.
fax # 0651-2400483 e-mail : cesd.jseb@gmail.com

Extension of Bid submission Date
In continuation to the E-tender floated vide NIT No. 212/PR/JBVNL/26-27 dt. 19.08.2026 for empanelment of agencies for repair of defective Power Transformer (PTRs) of various capacity (e.g. 5MVA, 10 MVA etc.) on rate contract under JBVNL.
It is pertinent to mention that the current last date of submission bid is 04.09.2026 (upto 6:00PM) hence, to ensure fare completion and adequate response the last date of bid submission and opening dates are proposed to be extended due to un-avoidable circumstances. The same available on the Jharkhand Government e-procurement portal (<https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>) on the tender schedule is hereby revised as under.

Sl. No	NIT No.	Description	Estimated value (incl. GST Rs.) (In Crs.)	EMD value (Incl. GST) (Rs. In lacs.)	Tender Cost (Incl. GST) (In Rs.)	Downloading / Sale of Tender Document	Pre-Bid Meeting	Last date of sale of tender document	Last Date of submission of bid	Date of Opening of Tender
1	212/PR/JBVNL/2026-27	Empanelment of agencies for repair of defective Power Transformer (PTRs) of various capacity (e.g. 5MVA, 10 MVA etc.) on rate contract under JBVNL.	8.13	16.26	11,800	19.08.26	01.09.26 at 3:00 PM	15.09.26 Up to 05:00PM	15.09.26 Up to 06:00PM	17.09.26 Up to 05:00PM

Further details against the above Tender can be obtained from website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> and may be contacted on Mobile No. 9006819264/ 8709711244& NIC helpline No. 0651-2400178, Email ID:-gm.stn@jbvnl.co.in. Submission of bid document fee and EMD will be accepted through online mode only and receipt/acknowledgement of tender submission of the same should be submitted to the office of undersigned on or before 17.09.2026.

Sd/-
General Manager (DN)
JBVNL

PR.No.387421
स्वहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में कर्त्ता बचावों। कृपया अपनी शिकायतों को टोल फ्री नं० 1800 345 6570 पर दर्ज करायें।

PR.No.388487 Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd(26-27):D

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
(1) Name of work with its location : Baragopal Yard remodeling work for removal of operational constraints at BAGL station. (2) Approx. cost of the works (₹) : ₹63.48,945/- (3) Earnest Money to be deposited (₹) : ₹ 1,27,000/- (4) Date & time for submission of tender and opening of tender: Opening of e-tenders: on 18.09.2026 at 12.00 Hrs. in the office of the Sr. Div. Electrical Engineer (TRD), DRM Office, E.C. Railway, Sonpur. (5) Website particulars and notice board location where complete details of e-tender can be seen.: WEBSITE : <http://www.ireps.gov.in> NOTICE BOARD: DRM Office Campus, E. C. Railway, Sonpur. Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD ECR/Sonpur
PR/0816/SEE/TRD/T/26-27/24

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
No. ECR/CAO/Con/WTE/Tender/ North/06-26-27 dated: 25.08.2026
E-TENDER NOTICE No. - ECR-CAO-C-N-ETN-06-26-27 E-TENDER is INVITED ON BEHALF OF THE PRESIDENT OF INDIA FOR THE UNDER MENTIONED WORK
(1)Name of work with its location: Launching/Erection, assembling and transportation of composite girder/open web girder and PSC girder/slab for super structure of major bridges, linking of track on bridge, Supply & fabrication of pathway materials, and other allied works from in connection with construction of SMI-SHEO New line in Samastipur division of E.C. Railway. (2)Approx. cost of the work of:Rs. 16,62,11,702.15 (3)Earnest money to be deposited: Rs. 33,24,200.00 (4)Date and time for closing of tender: 23.09.2026 at 14.30 hrs (5)Website particular, Notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen and addressed of the office from where the tender form be purchased etc: The above E-Tender, E-Tendering document alongwith full information is available on website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>.Note:In case of any discrepancies found in tender notice, English version will be final. Tenderers are requested to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> atleast 15 days before last date of closing for corrigendum/corrections etc in response to this E-tender
CAO/Con/North ECR Jy.MHX, Patna
PR/0805/CNN/MHX/CON/ST/26-27/40

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF Sh. Vivek Tomar
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division),
BAHADURGARH
RAJWANTI
Vs.
1. SUMIT
CASE No. CS/605/2025
CNR No. HRJRAO-001130-2025
Next Date 21-09-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
1. SUMIT
Father:-s/o JAGDISH S/o Rishal Singh 160, A Block, Kargil Apartments, Sector-18B, Dwarka, South West Delhi
Also At Village Asanda, Tehsil Bahadurgarh, Jhajjar
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 21-09-2026 at 10:00 am.
For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=districtnotice&district=Jhajjar>
Sd/- Sh. Vivek Tomar
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division),
dated 26-08-2026 **BAHADURGARH**

Chhattisgarh Rural Roads Development Agency
VIKASH BHAVAN, CIVIL LINES, RAIPUR (C.G.)
E-Procurement Tender Notice
NIT No. 1188 /TC-T/CGRRDA/2026 Dated 27/08/2026
Chief Engineer, CGRRDA, Raipur on behalf of Governor of Chhattisgarh invites package wise bids in electronic tendering system for, Construction & Maintenance of Road & Bridge under MMGSVY, sanctioned for districts of the state as per B.O.Q. from the eligible contractors / Firms registered with unified registration system (e-registration) for the works mentioned below. Date of release of Invitation for Bids through e-procurement:

S.N o	NIT No	Work Name	Amount (Rs. in Lakhs)	Districts	Rate invited
01	1188	Construction & Maintenance of Road & Bridge under MMGSVY	Total Cost 3696.64 Lakhs (Const. Cost 3566.49 Lakhs, Maint. Cost 130.14 lakhs.) (excluding GST)	Kabirdham, Jashpur, Mungeli, Dantewada, Bastar	Percentage Rate of PMGSY SOR 22.02.2018 & 06.06.2025 issued by CE, CGRRDA Raipur & PWD Bridge SOR 01.01.2025]

Availability of Bid Documents and mode of submission: The bid document is available online and should be submitted online in <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>. The bidder would be required to register in the web-site which is free of cost. For submission of the bids, the bidder is required to have a valid Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) from one of the authorized Certifying Authorities.

Detailed NIT and other details can be viewed on our website <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> from 31.08.2026 from 5:30 PM & onwards. In future any related corrigendum would be seen in the notice section of this website.

Digitally signed by
Krishna Kumar Katara
Date: 25-08-2026
13:16:05
Chief Engineer
Chhattisgarh Rural Road Development Agency
Civil Lines, Raipur (C.G.)
E-mail : pmgsyrc4@yahoo.co.in

Samvad 48890/3

PUBLIC NOTICE
Branch Office : ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005
Notice under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 is being issued by ICICI Bank Ltd. (on the underlying pool assigned to ICICI Bank by Dewan Housing Finance Ltd.) in relation to the enforcement of security concerning a Housing Loan Facility granted pursuant to a Loan agreement entered into between DHFL and the following borrower(s) who has/have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest towards the Loan Facility(ies) obtained by them from the secured creditor. The Loans have been classified as Non-Performing Assets (NPA), A notice was issued to them at their last known addresses; however, it has returned un-served and hence, they are hereby notified by way of this Public Notice.

Sr.	Name of the Borrower/Co-No./Borrower/ Guarantor/ & Address (DHFL Old LAN & ICICI New LAN)	Property Address of Secured Asset / Asset to be Enforced	Date of Notice Sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	Nagender Singh Negi/ Arti Negi/ Loan No. 19800041614/ QZPTU00004997716/ RZ 64 B Puran Nagar, Ground Floor Palam Colony, Delhi- 110045	Property Bearing No. RZ-110, First Floor Without Roof Rights, Out of Khasra No. 69/24, Along With One Bike Parking, Situated In The Area of Village Palam, Abadi Known As Raj Nagari-I, Palam Colony, New Delhi- 110045	06/08/2026 Rs. 12,72,650.99/-	08-Jun-2022

The steps are being taken for substituted service of Notice. The above borrower(s) and/or the guarantor(s) of the Loan (as applicable) is/are advised to make the payments of the outstanding within the period of 60 days from the date of the publication of this Notice also, further steps will be taken as per the provisions of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

Date: August 28, 2026
Place: Delhi/NCR
Authorised Officer
Team ICICI Bank

Government of Maharashtra
Office of the Commissioner of Police, Mumbai
Notice for Tender
Integrated Towing Van System for The Office of the Commissioner of Police, Mumbai on Design, Build, Operate and Maintain (DBOM) basis.
Office of the Commissioner of Police, Mumbai, Government of Maharashtra, invites proposals from reputed and experienced companies to participate in the competitive bidding process to Integrated Towing Van System for The Office of the Commissioner of Police, Mumbai on Design, Build, Operate and Maintain (DBOM) basis.
For the detailed Tender document, interested bidders should visit GeM (Government e-Marketplace) with Bid number GEM/2026/B/7944246, Dated 20-08-2026.
Tender submission would be online and the deadline to submit the proposals is 03-09-2026 upto 21.00.00

(Dr. Shrikant Paropkari)
Dy. Commissioner of Police (HO-I)
Mumbai

Dgipr/2026-27/2528

**दिल्ली विश्वविद्यालय**
UNIVERSITY OF DELHI

Advt. No. R&P/322/2026
Date: 31.07.2026

Online applications are invited in the prescribed Application Form from eligible candidates for appointment to the post of **Professor** in the Academic Pay Level-14 of the 7th Central Pay Commission Pay Matrix, in the Departments of **Chemistry, Environmental Studies, Genetics, Geology, Hindi, Linguistics, Operational Research, Philosophy, Zoology**, University of Delhi. The last date for receipt of applications is two weeks from the date of publication of the advertisement in the Employment News. For more details, please visit the University website www.du.ac.in and click "Jobs and Opportunities" under the Head "Work with DU".

Any addendum/corrigendum shall be posted only on the University website.

cbc 21231/11/0015/2627
REGISTRAR

**UJVN LIMITED**
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135 -2763808 & Fax: 0135- 2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvnl.uk.gov.in

Tender Notice
प.सं. 742 दिनांक: 27.08.2026
Office of the Executive Engineer, Project Distribution Division, Dakpathar (D.Dun), invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below :
Tender No. PDD-04/2026-27: AMC for 33kV lines from Dhakrani to 33/11 kV S/Station, Chibro, Khodri and other lines & misc. works under PDD.
Estimated cost: Rs. 17,37,468/- + GST extra respectively.
Date of availability of bid document on website : 28.08.2026
Last date for submission of tender: 18.09.2026 (Upto 01.00 PM)
For eligibility criteria and full & further details, kindly visit our web site. Tenders can only be downloaded from our website "www.ujvnl.uk.gov.in".
Executive Engineer (PDD)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Ram Mohan Singh S/o Mahender Singh R/o Village & P.O. Juniya Nahi, PS Gajner, Distt.-Kanpur (U.P.)**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **E-FIR No. 80019527/2026, U/S 305/316(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS Vasant Kunj North, South West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ram Mohan Singh** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ram Mohan Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Ram Mohan Singh** the said accused of **E-FIR No. 80019527/2026, U/S 305/316(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS Vasant Kunj North, South West Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Animesh Kumar
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02,
Room No. 32, Lok-Up Building,
Patiala House Courts, New Delhi

DP/12020/SW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Varun Jain, S/o, Mahender Jain, R/o: E-16 Om Vihar Phase-5, 40-Foota Road, Navada Dwarka, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 332/2018, U/s: 419/120B IPC**, registered at **P.S.: GTB Enclave, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Varun Jain** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Varun Jain** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Varun Jain, FIR No.:332/2018, U/s: 419/120B IPC**, registered at **P.S.: GTB Enclave, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.10.2026**.

By Order
Sanghmitra
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
Room No. 54, Second Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts Delhi

DP/11993/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ajay, S/o: Dalip, R/o: D-1/330, Sultanpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 157/2020, U/S: 394/397/411/34 IPC, Police Station Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ajay** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ajay** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ajay of Police Station Aman Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Muneesh Garg
Ld. ASJ-03, North-West,
3rd Floor, Room No. 304
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/12044/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Neelam, W/o Sh. Shyama @ Kamal Kapoor Raghuvver R/o H.No.B-59, Vijay Vihar, Phase-II, Rohini, B.D. Public School Ke Samne Wali Gali, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.753/2016 dated 24.12.2016 u/s 498A/406 IPC, P.S. Sultan Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Neelam** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Neelam** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Neelam of FIR No.753/2016 dated 24.12.2016 u/s 498A/406 IPC, P.S. Sultan Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.10.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Neha Goel
Metropolitan Magistrate, Court No.2, North-West
DP/12051/OD/2026 **Room No.18, Ground Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi**

Briefs

Barcelona signs Croatia goalkeeper

BARCELONA: Barcelona has signed Croatia goalkeeper Dominik Livakovic from Turkish club Fenerbahce Barcelona said Thursday that the 31-year-old Livakovic signed a contract until 2030. Livakovic is set to play a reserve role in a squad that already has Joan Garcia and veteran Wojciech Szczesny. Barcelona earlier this month sent Germany goalkeeper Marc-Andre ter Stegen to Ajax on a loan. Financial details of Livakovic transfer were not immediately available.

Another departure from MC

LONDON: Another signing for Tottenham, another departure at Manchester City. Egypt forward Omar Marmoush was sent to Tottenham on a season-long loan from City on Thursday, with the deal including an obligation to make the move permanent next summer — reportedly for 50 million pounds (\$68 million). While Tottenham has been one of the most active buying teams in Europe in this transfer window with an outlay of more than \$400 million, City has raised around \$400 million in sales and now has let its backup striker to Erling Haaland leave. Marmoush joined City from Eintracht Frankfurt in January 2025 for a reported 70 million euros but was never a regular under Pep Guardiola.

Nigeria football fed chief resigns

ABUJA: Ibrahim Gusau resigned as president of the Nigeria Football Federation on Thursday after mounting pressure that followed the country's failure to qualify for major tournaments. The federation said its general secretary Mohammed Sanusi has also resigned. Gusau, in the post since 2022, said he made the decision after consulting with stakeholders and family. The federation had launched a fact-finding committee to investigate the country's recent poor performances in international competitions.

CENTURION DINUSHA'S DOGGED EFFORT HELPS SL DRAW 2ND TEST

India win series 1-0 against Sri Lanka

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Colombo, August 27

Centurion Sonal Dinusha's unbending will en route an epic unbeaten 133 helped Sri Lanka enact a great jail break, battling persistent Indian bowlers, a fifth-day track and the weariness of following-on to eke out a memorable draw in the second and final Test here on Thursday. India won the two-match series 1-0, riding on their 165-run victory in the first Test at Galle, but Lanka can be proud of the way they fought back at the SSC ground. Dinusha, who faced 264 balls across 420 minutes, was Lanka's Superman with an invisible cape around him, registering his third hundred of the series which was also his fourth 50-plus score in as many innings this series. Dinusha faced as many as 722 balls and batted 1139 minutes over the course of the two-match series. The 25-year-old also became the only third batter to score twin hundreds in a Test match where his team followed-on, joining India's Vijay Hazare and Zimbabwe's Andy Flower in an elite club. This statistical marvel enabled Lanka to end their second innings at 429 for nine declared for an overall lead of 216 runs, and at that point the players shook their hands, signalling the stalemate.



India's Rishabh Pant, right, with Sri Lanka's Sonal Dinusha on day five of the second Test match between India and Sri Lanka on Thursday

But the situation was way different when Sri Lanka resumed the day at 229 for six, a mere 16

runs ahead. It seemed just a matter of time before the home side caved in. But the opposite hap-

pened as the Indians bowed to the spirit of the Lankan batters — Dinusha, who reached hundred in

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Dinusha faced as many as 722 balls and batted 1139 minutes over the course of the two-match series
- » Kumara fell to Jadeja, but Asitha Fernando (0 not out, 24 balls) stayed with Dinusha till the end

196 balls, and Keshara Nuwantha (46, 150b). The two milked 112 runs for the seventh wicket in 246 balls, which saw Lanka safely treading the first session without even losing a wicket. But India enjoyed a rare moment of delight in the initial part of the post-lunch passage, as Manav Suthar dislodged Nuwantha, whose edge was taken safely by Dhruv Jurel in the slip.

Sri Lanka then mounted a mini fightback through Dinusha and Prabath Jayasuriya (2, 28b). The eighth wicket pair added only 25 runs but took 74 balls for it, pushing the clock further. Ravindra Jadeja fetched another breakthrough as he jettisoned Jayasuriya, inducing an edge from the batter for Jurel in the second slip. But they ran into another obdurate Lankan — Lahiru Kumara (12, 122m, 90b), with whom Dinusha added 47 runs but consumed 170 balls to wipe out the hopes of a victory from Indians' hearts.

India beat Germany 3-1 to finish 5th in WC

It was the best finish in 52 years



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Amstelveen, August 27

The Indian women's hockey team pulled off a dominant 3-1 win over higher-ranked Germany in a classification match to finish a creditable fifth in the FIH World Cup, its best show in 52 years, here on Thursday. Navneet Kaur (44th and 47th) scored a brace to play a major role in the win as India ended their campaign on a high. Ishika (43rd minute) was the other goal getter for India. Lynn Krings pulled one back for Germany in the 59th minute. This was the Indian women team's best performance since finishing fourth in the inaugural World Cup in 1974 under Ajinder Kaur's leadership. The current Indian team has 11 World Cup debutants, and the fifth place finish makes it more noteworthy. Ninth-ranked India suffered just one defeat in the whole tournament --

NINTH-RANKED INDIA SUFFERED JUST ONE DEFEAT IN THE WHOLE TOURNAMENT -- AT THE HANDS OF OLYMPIC CHAMPIONS AND HOSTS THE NETHERLANDS (0-2)

at the hands of Olympic champions and hosts the Netherlands (0-2). This performance will undoubtedly boost the Indian team's confidence ahead of next month's Asian Games. The Indian team, which held Olympic silver medalist China to a 2-2 draw in the opening match, defeated South Africa 6-1 but then drew with England. Having eliminated from the semi-final race after a goal-less draw against Australia in the final match of the second round, India pulled out all the stops against Germany, scoring three goals in the final 17 minutes.

Mbappe scores hat trick in Real Madrid victory

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Madrid, August 27

Kylian Mbappé's first goals of the season came via a hat trick in Real Madrid's 4-1 victory over Real Sociedad in the Spanish league, while newcomer Sávio helped big-spending Tottenham rout Charlton 5-1 in the English League Cup. Vinícius Júnior also scored for Madrid in the team's first home game in José Mourinho's second stint in charge. In Champions League qualifying, Norway's Viking, Turkey's Fenerbahce, Greece's AEK Athens and Slovakia's Slovan Bratislava secured their spots in the competition's league phase. There was an altercation involving Fenerbahce players after the team's win at Lyon. Mbappé scored once in the first half and twice in the second to lead Madrid to its win over Sociedad in Mourinho's return to the Santiago Bernabeu Stadium.

NEXT UP IS ARSENAL IN THE PREMIER LEAGUE

Aston Villa in turmoil after big-name departures

ASSOCIATED PRESS
London, August 27

It was only three months ago that Aston Villa was celebrating a first major piece of silverware in 30 years and a return to the Champions League. It was only two weeks ago that Villa was pushing the mighty Paris Saint-Germain all the way in the UEFA Super Cup. All of a sudden, though,

there is an air of despondency around the club at the end of a summer when the spine of the team has been ripped out, leaving manager Unai Emery facing a major rebuild. Villa, which was hammered 4-0 by Brighton last weekend in their Premier League opener, will head into its home match against defending champion Arsenal on Monday without arguably its five

star players from last season: goalkeeper Emi Martinez, center back Ezri Konsa, midfielders Youri Tielemans and Morgan Rogers, and striker Ollie Watkins. Martinez, the World Cup-winning goalkeeper from Argentina, has been nowhere near the first team as he seeks a move away, possibly to Chelsea; Konsa, the England international, has joined Arse-

nal; Rogers and Tielemans have moved to Chelsea and Manchester United, respectively; and Watkins is reportedly off to Saudi Arabia, having yet to feature so far this season. Throw in left back Lucas Digne leaving to join PSG and it's quite the list of departures. "We're used to change," Villa captain John McGinn told the Stick to Football podcast, "and we'll try and

integrate new players and improve on last year. "I'm not naive enough to think that's not going to be more difficult now." Villa went through problems this time last year, opening the Premier League season with a five-match winless streak that saw questions asked about Emery's ability to get Villa firing again. They came through it -- but back then they had

Watkins and Rogers to get the team out of trouble. Now? Villa is reportedly close to signing Nicolas Jackson from Chelsea as a replacement for Watkins, but he isn't as reliable a striker. Johan Manzambi was signed from Freiburg off the back of a starring role for Switzerland at the World Cup, but he is only 20, new to the Premier League, and currently out injured.

Alcaraz opens US Open title defense against Safiullin

Venus Williams plays Sofia Kenin



ASSOCIATED PRESS
New York, August 27

Carlos Alcaraz will open the defense of his U.S. Open title against an opponent who made a strong run at Wimbledon while the Spaniard was sidelined with an injury. Along with some interesting opening-round matches, the draws for men's and women's singles Thursday delivered one what-could-have-been possibility: Had Serena Williams decided to play, there could have been a Williams sisters showdown

KEY POINTS

- » On Thursday, Venus Williams and Kenin were randomly drawn to face each other
- » Main draw play at the final Grand Slam tournament of the season begins Sunday

in Round 1. When Venus Williams was given a wild card into the event at 46, the U.S. Tennis Association initially held one spot, which surely

would have gone to Serena if the six-time U.S. Open champion wanted to play after returning to tennis for the first time since 2022. When the 44-year-old decided to only compete in doubles, the USTA awarded that last wild card over the weekend to American Sofia Kenin, the 2020 Australian Open champion. On Thursday, Venus Williams and Kenin were randomly drawn to face each other. Main draw play at the final Grand Slam tournament of the season begins Sunday.

News at a glance

'Putting in all hard work and hopes things fall in place'

MUMBAI: Having lost his spot in the national side, former India T20I captain Suryakumar Yadav on Thursday said he is putting in all the hard work and hoping for things to fall in place in future. A few months after leading India to their third T20 World Cup victory which was also their second consecutive title win, the 35-year-old Suryakumar was discarded from the team, considering his form and the two-year cycle of the next global event. Suryakumar's persistent struggles with the bat also seemed to have played a role in the selectors' decision.

Kaur says India not focusing on any particular team

DUBAI: India captain Harmanpreet Kaur on Thursday said her team is not singling out any opponent in the Women's T20 Asia Cup and will instead focus on playing good cricket, while expecting a challenging tournament with the standard of Asian teams improving rapidly. The Asia Cup features India, Pakistan, defending champions Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, hosts UAE, Thailand, Hong Kong China, and Indonesia. The ODI world champions India enter the Women's T20 Asia Cup as one of the favourites, but Harmanpreet played down the hype surrounding her team.

Dope test: UAE batter Asif Khan gets 15-month ban

DUBAI: UAE's Pakistan-born batter Asif Khan has been handed a 15-month ban after testing positive for a banned anabolic steroid during an out-of-competition test conducted last year. Asif tested positive for a metabolite of mesterolone, which is used to improve testosterone levels in a test conducted on September 8, 2025. "The 36-year-old admitted to a violation of Article 2.1 of the ICC Anti-Doping Code and accepted the sanction through a Case Resolution Agreement with the WADA and the International Cricket Council (ICC)," read a statement.



Team captains with the tournament trophy during a press conference ahead of the Women's T20 Asia Cup 2026 in Dubai

Public Notice: Lost of ID Card

I Geeta, D/O Rekha Devi, Residing H No- 176, Old D-38, Khasra No 534/2,36,37 And 547/41,42 3rd Floor Street No- 8, Jeevan Park City, North West Delhi, Delhi 110042 have lost my original SBI card Collection ID Card Number 2165364 of my name on behalf of RNFI Services Ltd. Finder may contact at Mobile Number 9560129773 Date: August 28, 2026 Place: Delhi

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Notification No. : DRMC/AGRA/2026/1-16 Dated : 27.08.2026

Public Notification

On behalf of President of India Senior Divisional Commercial Manager, North Central Railway, Agra invites applications for engagement of station ticket booking agent (STBA) on commission basis for issuing the unreserved Railway tickets through Computerised unreserved ticketing system (UTS) at 18 locations of 16 (NSG-4, NSG-5 & NSG-6 Category) Railway stations of Agra Division, for the period of (NSG-6 & NSG-5) 03 years and (NSG-4) Category Station till 20.05.2027 or instruction received from Railway Board.

Notification No. : 2026/01 To 2026/16

Nature of work - Engagement of STBA for 18 Location of 16 Stations (NSG-4, NSG-5 & NSG-6)

Earnest Money (EMD) in Rs. : (NSG-4-10,000/-NSG-5 - 5,000/- & NSG-6 - 2,000/-)

Cost of the Application form in Rs. : Rs. 1,000/- + 180 (18% GST) = Rs. 1,180/-

Each Non - Refundable.

Last date & time for purchasing of the application form : Date - 24.09.2026 by 17:00 hrs.

Date & Time for dropping the filled application form in the Box : Date - 25.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.

Date & time for the opening of applications : Date - 25.09.2026 at 11:30 hrs.

1. Details of station proposed for station Ticket Booking Agent (STBA) :-

Notification No.	Name of Station	Category	Code	Shift
2026/1	JHAREDA	NSG-6	JREA	24 Hrs.
2026/2	BHAINSA	NSG-6	BSA	24 Hrs.
2026/3	BIWAI	NSG-6	BW	24 Hrs.
2026/4	RUNDHI	NSG-6	RDE	24 Hrs.
2026/5	AGRA CITY	NSG-6	AGA	24 Hrs.
2026/6	CHHALESAR	NSG-6	CHLR	24 Hrs.
2026/7	GAZIKA	NSG-6	GZKA	24 Hrs.
2026/8	KITHAM	NSG-6	KXM	24 Hrs.
2026/9	BAAD	NSG-6	BAD	24 Hrs.
2026/10	FARAH	NSG-6	FAR	24 Hrs.
2026/11	RUNKUTA	NSG-6	RNKA	24 Hrs.
2026/12	ACHHNERA	NSG-5	AH	00:00-12:00 Hrs. ☐ 12:00-24:00 Hrs. ☐
2026/13	KOSI KALAN	NSG-4	KSV	00:00-12:00 Hrs. ☐ 12:00-24:00 Hrs. ☐
2026/14	RAJA KI MANDI	NSG-4	RKM	Platform No.-01 side 00:00-12:00 Hrs. ☐ Platform No.-02 side 12:00-24:00 Hrs. ☐
				Platform No.-01 side 00:00-12:00 Hrs. ☐ Platform No.-02 side 12:00-24:00 Hrs. ☐
2026/15	IDGAH	NSG-4	IDH	12:00-24:00 Hrs. ☐ Platform No.-04 side 00:00-12:00 Hrs. ☐ 12:00-24:00 Hrs. ☐
2026/16	DHOLPUR	NSG-4	DHO	12:00-24:00 Hrs. ☐

Note : A Person can apply for one Shift/one Platform side/one station only:

Office address from where Application form may be obtained : Applicant can obtain Application forms along with terms & conditions from the office of DRMC/N.C.R.-Agra on cash payment of Rs 1,000/-+180 (18% GST) = Rs 1,180/- to the Chief Booking Supervisor, Agra Cant in any working day from 31.08.2026 to date-24.09.2026 up to 17:00 hrs. The Application form is not transferable and its cost is Non Refundable.

Duration of work : According to Railway Board's letter No. 2018/TG-120/P/STBA Dated-14.08.2024, engagement of station ticket booking agent at NSG-5 & NSG-6 category Railway stations for the period of 03 years and Railway Board's letter No. 2018/TG-120/P/STBA dated - 20.05.2026 engagement of station ticket booking agent (STBA) at NSG-04 category railway stations till 20.05.2027 or instruction received from Railway Board.

Last date & time of depositing of Application form : Duly filled Sealed Application Form should be dropped in Tender Box Date - 25.09.2026 till 11:00 Hrs. and after that Tender Box will be sealed.

Date and Time of Opening of Application form/ Tender box : Application forms will be opened on 25.09.2026 at 11:30 hrs in the presence of Applicants. If the day of acceptance of Application form and the day of its opening is holiday the next working day will be the last day for submitting and opening of Application form.

Place of Submitting & Opening of Application form : Office of the Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager, DRMC Office, Agra Cant.

Website description and Notice Board where full details can be viewed : The Notification inviting Application, Application form, Terms and conditions are also available on the website of North Central Railway <https://ncr.indianrailways.gov.in/> as well as on Indian Government portal www.tenders.gov.in If the Notification documents are downloaded from the website, then, the applicant will have to attach the cost of Application form Rs 1,000/- +180 (18% GST) = Rs 1,180/- with Application form in the form of DD. (in original) issued by any Nationalized/Scheduled Bank in favour of Sr. Divisional Finance Manager N. C. Railway- Agra, otherwise the Application will be rejected. Application received after the date and time specified above will not be considered. Offer valid up to 90 days from the date of opening of application form.

Railway Administration keeps its right reserved to Cancel any one or all the Application forms without assigning any reason. 1998/26 (C)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPONC

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused 1. Ankit, S/o: Satbir, R/o: Village Firozpur, Bawana, Outer North, Delhi, 2. Rihana, R/o: J.J. Colony, Bawana, Outer North, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 354/2020, U/s 457/380/34 IPC, P.S.: Bawana, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused 1. Ankit, 2. Rihana cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused 1. Ankit, 2. Rihana have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said 1. Ankit, 2. Rihana accused of offence in case FIR No. 354/2020, U/s 457/380/34 IPC, P.S.: Bawana, Delhi and are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 10.12.2026.

By Order

Ms. Bharti Beniwal

Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)

DP/11984/ON/2026 Room No. 114, 1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Deepak, S/o: Shiv Ram, R/o: B-1010, Shahbad Dairy, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 339/2021 U/s 20/29 NDPS Act, P.S.: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Deepak cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Deepak has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Deepak accused of offence in case FIR No. 339/2021 U/s 20/29 NDPS Act, P.S.: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 06.10.2026.

By Order

Ms. Bharti Beniwal

Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)

DP/12048/ON/2026 Room No. 114, 1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

मध्य प्रदेश राज्य पर्यटन विकास निगम मर्यादित

पर्यटन भवन, भद्रभद्रा रोड, भोपाल-462003

फोन : +91-755-4027100, 2774340/42, www.mpstdc.com

क्रमांक 313/यात्रिकी/पवनि/26 दिनांक : 27.08.2026

अल्पावधि निविदा सूचना

313/2026_STDC_532656_1

मध्य प्रदेश राज्य पर्यटन विकास निगम भोपाल द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु ऑनलाइन (Online) निविदा प्रपत्र APPENDIX 2.10 पर म.प्र. लोक निर्माण विभाग में उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से आमंत्रित की जाती है। कार्य का नाम- जिला दत्तिया स्थित पीताम्बरा पीठा एवं मल्टी लेबल पार्किंग हेतु बाहरी विद्युतीकरण, इल्यूमिनेशन एवं सर्विलेंस सिस्टम का कार्य। (कार्य पूर्णता का समय 06 माह)। कार्य की अनुमानित लागत राशि रु. 491.97 लाख

वेबसाइट पर ऑनलाइन भुगतान कर निविदा प्रपत्र (टेंडर डॉक्यूमेंट) वेबसाइट के माध्यम से क्रय किये जा सकते हैं। निविदा प्रपत्र ऑनलाइन क्रय करने की अंतिम तिथि 07.09.2026 समय सायं 05:00 बजे तक निर्धारित है। कार्य का विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाइट <https://mptenders.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है।

म.प्र. माध्यम/127800/2026 कार्यपालन यंत्री

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Rajesh S/o Rampal R/o F-14, Jhuggi, Shahbad Dairy, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide FIR No. 148/2020 U/S 411 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused Rajesh can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Rajesh has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Rajesh of FIR No. 148/2020 U/S 411 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of 07.10.2026.

By Order,

Ms. Bharti Beniwal

Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)

Room No. 114, 1st Floor

Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/12056/ON/2026(Court Matter)



पर्यावरण, वन एवं जलवायु परिवर्तन विभाग

कार्यालय:-वन प्रमंडल पदाधिकारी, पटना पार्क प्रमंडल, पटना

Rajdhani Vatika (Eco Park) 800001, Near Old Secretariat, Gate no.-2, Off Mall Road, Patna

(Ph. No. 0612-2339991, Email address: parkdivisionpatna@gmail.com)

e-Tender Notice No-14/2026-27

1	विज्ञापनदाता का नाम एवं पता	वन प्रमंडल पदाधिकारी, पटना पार्क प्रमंडल, पटना
2	निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत की तिथि	दिनांक-25.08.2026
3	निविदा प्रपत्र प्राप्त करने की तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक-29.08.2026 समय-11:00 A.M से दिनांक-12.09.2026 05:00 P.M तक। (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
4	संबंधित द्वारा निविदा अपलोड की अंतिम तिथि	दिनांक-13.09.2026 के समय 05:00 P.M बजे तक। (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
5	तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि	दिनांक-14.09.2026 के समय-03:00 P.M बजे। (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
6	वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि	तकनीकी बीड में सफल होने के उपरान्त।

पटना पार्क प्रमंडल अंतर्गत निम्नांकित पार्कों में कंपेंडेटेरिया संचालन हेतु निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है:-

क्र.सं.	निविदा का विवरण	अग्रघन की राशि (Online के माध्यम से) (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)	प्रतिभूति राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य (Online के माध्यम से) (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)	निविदा का अवधि
1	पाटलिपुत्रा पार्क सं. 138 (अटल पार्क) कंपेंडेटेरिया	रु. 50,000 /-	4 माह के किराये की राशि	रु. 2000 /-	(दो वर्ष)

Detailed description of the terms and conditions as well as tender form for submission of tender can be downloaded from <https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in>

Corrigendum/Attendum, if any, will be published after on the departmental website <https://state.bihar.gov.in/forest/> and e-procurement Portal Bihar .

वन प्रमंडल पदाधिकारी

पटना पार्क प्रमंडल, पटना

विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

PR. No.010627 (Forest) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT e-Procurement Notice INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, Division Kasumpti HPPWD, Shimla-3, H.P on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the Percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class of contractors registered with HPPWD for the works as detailed in the table.

Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost	Form Cost	Starting date for download-Bid	Earnest Money	Deadline for submission of Bid	Time Allowed
1	Restoration of rain damages on Bhattakuffer to AIMSS Chamanya road km. 0/00 to 2/400. (SH- Providing safety protection from hill side includes B/wall between km. 1/340 to 1/500 near via duct on the effected portion of NHAI (Excluding GST) (Against Court matter CWPII 38/2024).	5036219	2000	29-08-2026	100800	07-09-2026	60 days
2	A/R & M/O various Type-I & Type-VI GAD Qtrs at Kasumpti Shimla-171009 (SH- P/F Covering at Periphery of Type-VI Set no. 3 with Cantonment wire Under Kasumpti Section). (Excluding GST)	152608	350	29-08-2026	3100	07-09-2026	30 days
3	A/R & M/O various residential Qtrs at Kasumpti Shimla-171009 (SH- P/FMS Jafri and polycarbonate in Type-V & VI at Kasumpti Shimla). (Excluding GST)	211208	350	29-08-2026	4300	07-09-2026	30 days
4	A/R & M/O on Kalkar Bagora to Shahal road Km 0/000 to 2/00 (SH- Construction of PCC. Retaining wall Rd.1/350 to 1/370) . (Excluding GST)	472305	350	29-08-2026	9500	07-09-2026	30 days
5	Restoration of rain damages on Dumni to Karechi road km. 0/00 to 10/165 (SH- Removal of Slips various Rds) . (Excluding GST)	420010	350	29-08-2026	8500	07-09-2026	30 days
6	Repair & Maintenance of Govt. Senior Secondary School building at Mashobra Shimla. (SH- Repair of Building) (Balance work) (Excluding GST)	387660	350	29-08-2026	8000	07-09-2026	30 days
7	Restoration of rain damages to Bhattakuffer to Koli road Km 0/000 to 5/005. (SH-Providing protection work to head wall of culvert at km.0/980 and paver blocks in km. 1/128 to 1/145) . (Excluding GST)	626441	350	29-08-2026	12600	07-09-2026	30 days
8	A/R & M/O on Shoghi Mehli Junga Sadhupul Road Km. 12/375 to 48/925. (SH- C/O R/Wall at R/D 29/250 to 29/264.50) . (Excluding GST)	423223	350	29-08-2026	8500	07-09-2026	30 days
9	A/R & M/O various Residential Qtrs under Kasumpti Shimla-171009. (SH- Repair of damaged roof due to fire incident in Type-III Set no.115 at Kasumpti Shimla-9.) (Excluding GST)	401147	350	29-08-2026	8100	07-09-2026	30 days
10	A/R & M/O on Shoghi Mehli Junga Sadhupul Road Km. 12/375 to 48/925. (SH- C/O R/Wall at R/D 40/195 to 40/216) . (Excluding GST)	616132	350	29-08-2026	12400	07-09-2026	30 days
11	A/R & M/O on Shoghi Mehli Junga Sadhupul Road Km. 12/375 to 48/925. (SH- C/O R/Wall at R/D 40/216 to 40/235) . (Excluding GST)	554327	350	29-08-2026	11100	07-09-2026	30 days
12	A/R & M/O various Type- III to Type- IV GAD Qtrs at Parimahal , Kasumpti, Shimla-9. (SH- External Repair and Painting in Type- III G and H Block under Parimahal Section). (Excluding GST)	534925	350	29-08-2026	10700	07-09-2026	30 days

The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website www.hptender.gov.in. The reserves the right to accept/reject any tender/application or all tenders without assigning any reason. R.No 2984/2026-2027

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM

Notice No. W.584/E-Tendering/163-DHN -2026-27 Dhanbad, Dated, 25.08.2026

It is further to notify that, the E-Tender No. 163-DHN-2026-27 dtd. 05.08.2026 is hereby Cancelled due to administrative reason.

Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.) East Central Railway, Dhanbad. PR/0804/DHN/ENGG/C/26-27/16

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

(1)Name of work with its location: Modification of OHE in lieu of (i) Provision of RUB in lieu of LC No-9C b/w GTHT-LLJP at KM 19.123. (ii) Provision of Limited height sub-way in lieu of LC No. 23 between DGA-BAGL. (iii) Provision of Limited height sub-way in lieu of LC No. 5 between PMU-SEE. (iv) Provision of Limited height sub-way in lieu of LC No. 04 between BCA-VPDA (v) Provision of RUB in lieu of LC No-18 b/w KHI-GRL at KM 32.965 (2)Approx. cost of the works (₹) ₹46,43,982/- (3)Earnest Money to be deposited (₹) ₹. 92,900/- (4)Date & time for submission of e-tender and opening of e-tender :Opening of e-tenders: on 18.09.2026 at 12.00 Hrs. in the office of the Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer (TRD), DRM Office, E.C. Railway, Sonpur (5)Website particulars and notice board location where complete details of e-tender can be seen: WEBSITE: <http://www.ireps.gov.in> NOTICE BOARD: DRM Office Campus, E. C. Railway, Sonpur. Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD East Central Railway/Sonpur PR/0813/SEE/TRD/26-27/32

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

On behalf of President of India, Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom. Engineer, S. E. Railway, Adra, Pin-723121, West Bengal invites following e-tenders: SI. No., Tender Notice No., Name of Work, Tender Value: (1) SnT_e_Tender_ ADA_26_27_28; Provision of Automatic Fire Detection and Alarm System with Aspiration Type Air Sampling Detectors at 10 LC Gates and Aspiration Type Air Sampling Detectors at Stations, interfacing with the existing AFADS at 27 Stations over Adra Division: ₹1,91,22,628.00 (2) SnT_e_Tender_ ADA_26_27_29; S&T work in connection with (i) construction of a limited-height subway in lieu of LC Nos.PK-6 & PK-24 and (ii) Construction of a limited-height subway in lieu of LC No. AM 39, AM-51 & MC-2 of Adra Division: ₹54,71,879.68 Closing Date & Time of tenders are 17/09/2026 11:00 Hrs. Details are available at website www.ireps.gov.in.

(PR-674)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

(E-Auction Notice)

Sr.Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS (<http://ireps.gov.in>) for the allotment of Automated Teller Machine/Digital Banking Unit/Banking e-Lobby Contracts, at following Railway stations/locations:-

E-Catalogue No	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Sites
DLI-ATM-04-2026	15.09.2026 at 12.00 Hrs	Anand Vihar Terminal (2), Tohana (1), Jakhal (1), Noli (1),
Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen		https://ireps.gov.in/

All bidders who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

- Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing Module -Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module

-Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Update of Turnover Details A New mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism. The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in state bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account which enables them to participate in IREPS E-auctions.

- Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors/Contractors (E-Tender/E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query	Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi 110055. Email: publicitycellndi@gmail.com Tel: 011-23743084
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No. 3PUB/ATM/DLI-DIV/E-auction/2022 Dated: .08.2026 2977/2026 Serving Customers With A Smile

कार्यालयक अभियंता का कार्यालय, सिंघाई प्रमंडल सं०-1 बरहेट

(Email-ecird1barhait@gmail.com)

e-procurement Tender Notice

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या- 01/2026-27

निविदा संदर्भ संख्या-WRD/IRR/BARHAIT/F2-01/2026-27 दिनांक-27 / 08 / 2026

- विभाग का नाम- जल संसाधन विभाग, झारखण्ड सरकार
- विज्ञापन दाता का नाम- कार्यपालक अभियंता, सिंघाई प्रमंडल सं०-1, बरहेट
- निविदा वेबसाइट पर प्रकाशन की तिथि- 03 / 09 / 2026
- परिमाण विपत्र डाउनलोड करने की अवधि- 05 / 09 / 2026 से 15 / 09 / 2026 तक
- निविदा प्राप्त करने की अंतिम तिथि- 15 / 09 / 2026 5:00 PM
- निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय- 18 / 09 / 2026 3:00 PM
- कार्य का विवरण-

क्र०	कार्य का नाम	
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He was known for his roles as Dr Frank-N-Furter in 'The Rocky Horror Picture Show' and the smug concierge in 'Home Alone 2: Lost in New York'



TIM CURRY (1946-2026)

THE ICONIC CHARACTER GIFTED STAR

Tim Curry, a character actor who created a gallery of delicious, very loony villains for stage and screen, including Dr Frank-N-Furter in 'The Rocky Horror Picture Show' and the smug concierge in 'Home Alone 2: Lost in New York', has died. He was 80.

Curry, who suffered a stroke in 2012 that put him in a wheelchair, died Tuesday night at his home in Los Angeles, according to his longtime manager and friend Marcia Hurwitz. No cause was disclosed. Known for his arch humour, a puttylike face and gift with voices, Curry

earned three Tony nominations - for 'Spamalot', 'My Favorite Year' and 'Amadeus' - and a Primetime Emmy nod in 1994.

"I like playing the more curious corners of the human mind and human behaviour, partly because they're a tad more interesting," Curry told 'The Associated Press' in 1993.

Curry burst onto the scene as the Transylvanian Frank-N-Furter in the sci-fi, cross-dressing rock musical 'The Rocky Horror Show', which premiered in 1973 at the Royal Court Theatre in London. He went with it to Broadway and then starred in the 1975 cult-classic movie alongside Barry Bostwick, Meat Loaf and Susan Sarandon.

The show was ahead of its time in terms of its representation of LGBTQ+ characters and has entered the pop culture lexicon for its many iconic and memorable scenes, including the song 'The Time Warp', which has been covered by a handful of artists and the often-quoted



HIS SCREEN CREDITS INCLUDED STARRING AS THE CHILD-KILLING MONSTER IN THE 1990 MINISERIES VERSION OF STEPHEN KING'S HORROR NOVEL 'IT', AS A MEDICAL OFFICER IN 'THE HUNT FOR RED OCTOBER' IN 1990 AND THE DOUBLE-DEALING CARDINAL RICHELIEU IN 1993'S 'THE THREE MUSKETEERS'

phrase, "Dammit, Janet!" The show was twice revived on Broadway, most recently in 2026 with Luke Evans playing Frank-N-Furter.

"He was a force, a bright fierce flame, an exquisite charm and that rich vocal tone," Evans wrote on 'Instagram'. "I hope, wherever you are, you'd approve of one more Frank having the time of his life in those heels."

Curry's Frank-N-Furter had a posh British accent, but that almost wasn't the case. He said he tried German and American accents but pivoted after he heard a British

woman on a bus talking with her friend. "I met a woman on a bus who said, 'Do you have a house in town or a house in the country?' and I thought, 'That's the voice!'" he told LA Magazine in 2015.

For many years after the film's premiere, the British-born actor declined to discuss it. He didn't participate in activities promoting the film, which morphed into an interactive event at midnight shows. But he later warmed up again to the project and embraced it at public events. Asked by LA Magazine how he viewed 'Rocky Horror', he



responded: "With a sort of bemused tolerance. It's neither a blessing nor a curse. I was lucky to get it."

Curry's Broadway career included starring in Tom Stoppard's 'Travesties' in 1975-76, playing Mozart opposite Ian McKellen's Antonio Salieri in Peter Shaffer's 'Amadeus' and King Arthur in the 2005 production of 'Spamalot'. The New York Times said his 'stalwart, plummy-voiced Arthur wears a smile as inflexible as armour'. He also played Scrooge in 'A Christmas Carol', at the Theater at Madison Square Garden in 2001.

His screen credits included starring as the child-killing monster in the 1990 miniseries version of Stephen King's horror novel 'It', as a medical officer in 'The Hunt for Red October' in 1990 and

the double-dealing Cardinal Richelieu in 1993's 'The Three Musketeers' with Kiefer Sutherland, Charlie Sheen and Chris O'Donnell. "Tim Curry was someone I cared deeply about. He was someone I loved working with and I am so lucky to have these memories," Sutherland said.

In his 2025 memoir, 'Vagabond', Curry warned readers that while there were scraps of his nature in his characters, he was none of them. "The distinctions between who I really am and who I've pretended to be as an actor have proven to be a source of great disappointment to some audiences. It has not caused me much personal distress beyond the periodic necessity to deter stalkers," he wrote.

Born in Cheshire, England, Curry was the son of a Navy chaplain and a school secretary. He was 12 when his father died and his mother subsequently went to work. Young Tim learned to cook his own breakfast, resulting in a life-long passion for cooking and sharpening his humour muscles. "My father was a Methodist chaplain in the Navy and we moved pretty much every 18 months," he said. "So, I had to make my mark in new schools and new playgrounds pretty quickly. And a sense of humour is the best way to do that. I was always a kind of mimic, one of those awful, relentless children." AGENCIES

'12 12 12' to premiere on Apple TV in November

Apple TV unveiled the first look at its upcoming heist drama '12 12 12', starring Anthony Mackie and Jamie Dornan, with the eight-episode series set to premiere globally on November 13.

The series will premiere with its first two episodes, followed by one episode every Friday through December 25, the streamer said in a press release.

Created by Dudi Appleton and Jim Keeble, '12 12 12' unfolds a heist across three timelines: the 12 months of planning, the 12 hours of the heist and the 12 days that follow. The series follows a disgraced



FBI agent, played by Mackie and an American career criminal, portrayed by Dornan, as they engage in a cat-and-mouse game across Europe. At the centre of the story is an ambitious raid on a bank vault deep beneath the streets of Zurich.

The ensemble cast



includes Jack Kesey, Agathe Rousselle, Sallie Harmsen, José García, Kali Reis and others.

Emmy Award-nominated and BAFTA Award-winning filmmaker Kari Skogland directs multiple episodes, including the pilot and also serves as an executive producer. PTI

BIRTH ANNIVERSARY

Asha Bhosle's final film song to be released

Titled 'Ae Meri Zindagi, Tu Chupi Hai Kahan', the song was recorded in late 2023

Legendary playback singer Asha Bhosle's final recorded film song will be released on her birth anniversary on September 8 as part of the upcoming drama-comedy 'Om Ka Hari', the makers announced.

Titled 'Ae Meri Zindagi, Tu Chupi Hai Kahan', the song was recorded in late 2023, when Bhosle was in her 90s. It will feature in filmmaker Harish Vyas' father-son drama, starring Anshuman Jha, Raghubir Yadav, Soni Razdan and Ayesha Kapur.

Bhosle, who ruled Bol-



lywood for over seven decades and recorded over 12,000 songs, including hits like 'Dum Maro Dum', 'Piya Tu Ab To Aaja', 'Chura Liya Hai Tumhe Jo Dil Ko' and 'Yeh Mera Dil',

passed away in April this year at the age of 92.

The song is described as a tribute to life, celebrating the joy of living, love and the importance of expressing one's feel-

ings. Its release on Bhosle's birth anniversary is intended as a celebration of her enduring musical legacy and contribution to Indian cinema.

"Launching the song on her birthday is intended as a celebration of Asha Ji's timeless voice, her immense legacy and the generations of listeners whose lives her music has touched," Vyas said.

According to the makers, 'Om Ka Hari' explores the generational conflict between a father and son and centres on the emotions that often remain

unspoken within families.

For Jha, who also stars in and has a connection to the film's story, Bhosle's voice adds a deep personal dimension to the narrative. "'Om Ka Hari' is deeply special to me because, at its heart, it is about the importance of saying 'I love you' to your father, something I never got the chance to do. To have Asha Ji's voice carry the song that represents the catharsis of the film is one of the most profound and memorable moments of my life as an artist," he said. PTI

Viral Feed



HUMA QURESHI poses in a stylish black suit during the release of her movie 'Toxic'

'Respect isn't playlisted'

Amaal Mallik broke his silence on the 'Yeh Awarapan' backlash from 'Awarapan 2'

Amaal Mallik addressed the wave of criticism directed at 'Yeh Awarapan', his composition for 'Awarapan 2', in a lengthy and emotional note on 'Instagram'. Alongside defending the song's artistic intent, the composer alleged that a coordinated, paid PR effort was behind much of the negativity surrounding the track.

Starting his post with the phrase 'Khauff Machaaya Ve', Amaal reflected on what he described as a genuinely difficult stretch leading up to this point. He cited advice his mother had given him to stay away from the



industry altogether. "All the naysayers can go and kindly bawl their eyes out... Yes, we are successful today, but the last three weeks have been horrendous and I realise now why my mother

said, 'Don't join this industry'. She said the 'music industry' is worse than the 'acting industry', lol... Imagine!" he wrote.

He urged people not to reduce a song's worth to its early numbers, adding, "Don't compare numbers, data and momentum with love, sweat, tears, blessings and a lotta magic."

Amaal also detailed the creative thinking behind the track, describing

its sound as a fusion of 'Alternative Glam Rock', Sufi lyricism and classic Bollywood melancholy. "The genre is Alternative Glam Rock, with Sufism in its writing + Bollywood Melancholy presented as a simple conversation of a man with the love of his life who has left this realm," he explained.

He noted that he deliberately avoided drawing from the original film's musical elements, calling the project deeply personal. AGENCIES

